THE TANDEM COMPANION · BUILD 1

3 SHADOWMERE LANE
THE UNDERSIDE

Standalone 3SL Companion · Reference + Working Pages

AUTHORED COPY	The Tandem Companion — Content Master, Stage 3 · Sep 26, 2026
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AUTHOR RULINGS	TCD-001–064 · Graveshand five laws (2026-08-22) · Underside tier status (2026-10-09)
ASSEMBLED	2026-10-09

VOLUME NOTE · BUILD 1

B1 ABOUT THIS VOLUME

What this standalone volume holds, and how to read its references.

This is Build 1 of the Tandem Companion: a standalone working volume for *3 Shadowmere Lane* and the Underside. It carries Part I (how the Companion works) in full, the Part II sections a 3SL scene stands on, and all of Part III. The copy is the locked Stage 3 Content Master; this volume lays it out and adds working pages. It doesn't add canon.

Some pages point to sections that live only in the full Tandem Companion. Two conventions keep those pointers honest:

- **Continuity Room pointers resolve here.** References to VII.1, VII.2, VII.3, VII.4, VII.5, VII.7, VII.10 and VII.12, and to the FTE sections IV.14, IV.15 and IV.17, lead to the 3SL Continuity Room concordance near the end of this volume, which names where the 3SL information already sits in these pages.
- **Everything else outside the volume carries a dagger (†).** A reference marked † is to a section of the full Tandem Companion that isn't printed here.
- **Page numbers.** "See also" chips give the page where each in-volume section starts.

AUTHOR CORRECTION APPLIED IN THIS VOLUME

One author ruling post-dates the Content Master and is applied wherever the claim appears (III.3; III.20 working pages): the Underside tier status. It is logged in Appendix A under "Author rulings without a TCD number."

AUTHOR RULING · 2026-10-09 · UNDERSIDE TIER STATUS

● CANON	The Underside is vertically tiered and attached to Zenithia's side of Remnia; Crownlight and Dawnveil are surface/above-ground tiers; the nation is fully underground by Ironcross.	TCD-025 · TCD-026
■ DRAFTED	The Underside has nine tiers; Halflight's old route board lists all nine in order.	3SL ch. 10
◪ SUPPORTED	Tier functions and other worldbuilding detail where not independently drafted or ruled.	3SL Full Worldbuilding

WHAT ISN’T IN THIS VOLUME

Parts IV–VII (FTE, ADST, TSWK and the full Continuity Room), the Part II sections that don’t bear on 3SL (II.1, II.6–II.13, II.15), and Appendix D. The appendices printed here are 3SL slices: the rulings, conflicts, sources and terms this volume cites.

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PART I · BUILD 1

HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

This Part teaches you to trust a page in under ten minutes. Every later Part assumes you know what a status marker permits, which source wins in which domain, and why a character can't know something just because you do.

§	SECTION	PAGE TYPE	PAGE
I.1	What the Tandem Companion Is	ORIENTATION	7
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ORIENTATION · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.1 WHAT THE TANDEM COMPANION IS

Frame the book as a working writer-room reference, not a wiki or workbook.

The Tandem Companion is the working reference for four novels set in one physical world: *3 Shadowmere Lane*, *For Their Entertainment*, *A Dream So Twisted*, and *The Sea Will Keep*. It holds the canon those books have already committed to, the rulings that settled their contradictions, and the open questions they haven't answered yet. It sits beside the manuscript while you draft. It isn't a replacement for it.

The Companion does five jobs. It remembers what's been ruled and drafted so you don't have to reread three generations of files to find out. It distinguishes things a drafter will blur: the Nightmare organization from the ancient entity, Katherine's Frost from Zephyr's, the forensic record of Remy's death from Melena's guilt about it. It connects the books only where a ruling or source connects them. It protects chronology and knowledge, so nobody in 3SL behaves as if they've read ADST. And it catches resurrected ideas, the retired concepts that keep sneaking back because they were once written down with confidence.

It refuses a few jobs on purpose. It won't fill a gap because the gap looks awkward in print. It won't pick the nicer version of a conflict. It won't invent a sigil, a motto, a date, a map coordinate, or a line of scripture to make a page feel finished. It isn't a fan wiki, a marketing synopsis, or a workbook of blank lines waiting for you to do the thinking. When the sources don't know something, the Companion says so plainly, and that sentence is worth more than a confident guess.

FOUR BOOKS, FOUR LANDS

BOOK	LAND	POINT OF VIEW	CONTROLLING GENERATION	WHERE THE DRAFTING STANDS
***3 Shadowmere Lane* (3SL)**	The Underside	Alternating Silas Graves / Isola Wraithmoor chapters (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)	*3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft*, 22 chapters, revised through 2026-08-19	Drafted through ch. 22; the draft stops with Remy alive and the transit route unresolved. The 32-chapter outline controls only its fixed anchors (TCD-002).
***For Their Entertainment* (FTE)**	Remnia	Katherine Nicholas / Melena Lockwood chapters (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)	*FTE Official Beta Reader Copy*, through ch. 29	Endgame heavily ruled but undrafted in the controlling generation. The Chapter 29 fragment and chs. 31–39 require rewrite before they count (TCD-001).
***A Dream So Twisted* (ADST)**	Somnoria	Reverie Hollow chapters confirmed on-page; any additional POV is confirmed in Part V†	*ADST*, 19 chapters	Draft ends before the rebuilt Network-rupture climax, which is ruled at outcome level (TCD-060–061).
***The Sea Will Keep* (TSWK)**	Thalara	Dual Azrine / Levi (established premise)	No manuscript. *Thalara Worldbuilding* and *Azrine and Levi* govern; the July 2026 44-chapter blueprint is provisional by claim	Ending open (TCD-012).

Why the table matters: a drafter who asks "what's true?" has to ask it about a specific book, because each book stands at a different stage. 3SL has a controlling draft and a partly retired outline. TSWK has no draft at all, so its most detailed plan is still only a plan. The same kind of question gets a different kind of answer depending on the row.

SOURCE *Audit, Source Inventory; TCD-001, TCD-002, TCD-003, TCD-012; 3SL draft chs. 1–12 (POV headings); FTE Beta chs. 8, 18 (POV headings); ADST ch. 18 (POV heading).*

SEE ALSO I.2 The Manuscript Outranks the Companion · **p.10**

I.3 How Source Authority Works · **p.12**

RULE · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.2 THE MANUSCRIPT OUTRANKS THE COMPANION

State the single rule that keeps the Companion subordinate to the books.

Drafted prose controls drafted events. If a chapter in the controlling generation shows something happening, it happened, and the Companion records it. If that chapter deliberately changes something the Companion already printed, the Companion changes. A printed page never gets to veto a scene.

That rule has limits that matter as much as the rule. The manuscript controls what it actually shows: POV, scene order, revealed identities, performed magic, relationships, and immediate consequences. It doesn't automatically control national geography, deep history, or magical taxonomy just because a character says something about them. When Silas thinks nobody born in the Underside carries fire, that's a drafted fact about what Silas believes. It becomes world-level canon only if a ruling or the governing worldbuilding agrees. A manuscript can also be wrong by accident. A typo, a stray name from an older generation, or a detail that contradicts a ruling isn't a deliberate change; it's a drafting flag, and the Companion logs it as one instead of rewriting canon around it.

Open and provisional material works the other way. Where the Companion marks something ○ OPEN or ◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL, drafting is allowed to settle it. When a scene commits to an answer on purpose, that commitment becomes the new record, and the Companion's update protocol (I.6) moves the old version to the Legacy Recovery Index rather than deleting it.

GUARDRAIL

Never bend a scene to match a Companion page. If the scene is right and the page is wrong, fix the page. If the scene contradicts an author ruling (a TCD), stop and decide which one you mean; don't let either quietly win.

Why it matters: the Companion is only trustworthy if it can't become a second, rival manuscript. The moment a printed entry starts dictating prose, the books stop being written and start being transcribed from an index.

I.2 · THE MANUSCRIPT OUTRANKS THE COMPANION

CONTINUED

SOURCE *Audit, Preliminary Domain-Based Source Authority Map, rule 2; Production Master A1; 3SL draft ch. 3 (Silas's belief about Underside fire).*

SEE ALSO I.6 Open Canon, Decisions, and Updates · **p.21**

VII.12 Open Canon Queue → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

I.3 HOW SOURCE AUTHORITY WORKS

Teach the domain-specific ladder so a reader knows why a claim is trusted.

Authority is domain-specific. A source can settle one kind of fact and have no say over another. The 3SL draft is the last word on what happens in Dante Mercer's office in chapter 3; it isn't the last word on how far Crownlight sits above sea level. The Thalara worldbuilding file governs Thalaran geography; it can't overrule a ruling about the Drowning. Every claim in this book is trusted because of the rung it stands on in its own domain.

THE AUTHORITY LADDER

RUNG	SOURCE TYPE	WHAT IT CONTROLS	WHAT IT CAN'T DO
1	Explicit author rulings (Canon Decision Log, TCD-001 onward)	Every domain a ruling addresses	Nothing outranks it except a later ruling
2	Current manuscript pages	What happened on-page: POV, scene chronology, revealed identity, performed magic, relationships, immediate consequences	Settle geography, history, or taxonomy by a character's say-so
3	Locked constraints (*Novel Constraints*, as corrected by rulings)	Intended premise and undrafted core engine	Override a drafted scene or a later ruling
4	Current outlines and chapter plans	Undrafted plot, once their generation is confirmed	Overwrite anything already drafted
5	Current book-specific worldbuilding, character, magic, and institutional files	Geography, institutions, culture, baseline magic, backstory where the manuscript is silent	Contradict a ruling or an on-page event
6	Shared Tandem lore	Its claims one at a time, only where they survive review	Serve as a blanket master plan
7	Supporting artifacts (timelines, placement tables, genealogy workbooks, poems, quote maps)	Their narrow domain, after consistency checks	Fill gaps outside that domain
8	Marketing files	Positioning language	Establish any canon

RUNG	SOURCE TYPE	WHAT IT CONTROLS	WHAT IT CAN'T DO
9	Legacy drafts and plans	Creative history and recovery leads	Answer a current question
10	TKC Companion materials	Structural and philosophical models only	Contribute any Tandem canon, ever

Two rules sit above the ladder. First, the Tandem Source Authority Audit's rulings override conflicting source material wherever they speak. Second, filenames and dates confer nothing. "FINAL," "Official," "New," and a recent year are labels a file picked up along the way. *FTE 2025 FINAL* is Legacy. *New FTE Chapters* predates the modern Remnia execution. A later date on the TSWK blueprint doesn't make it a ruling.

Worked example: the Beta versus the 2025 FINAL. *FTE 2025 FINAL* is a complete 47-chapter manuscript. The *FTE Official Beta Reader Copy* stops at chapter 29. A reader who trusts completeness picks the FINAL and gets the ending for free. TCD-001 says no: the Beta is the controlling prose generation, and nothing outside it becomes canon until it's rewritten into that generation. The FINAL still earns its shelf space as planning evidence for the unfinished half, but its simple Dyad/Crossblood explanation, its reveal shortcut, its cause for Atlas's deterioration, and its Tiran-only forfeit are all superseded by TCD-049 through TCD-052. The complete file lost to the incomplete one because the incomplete one is the book being written.

CURRENT CONTROLLING GENERATIONS AT A GLANCE

BOOK	CONTROLS DRAFTED EVENTS	SUPPORTS UNDRAFTED WORK	STATUS OF THE REST
3SL	*3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft*, 22 chapters	32-chapter outline for fixed anchors only; *3SL Character Outlines*; *3SL Full Worldbuilding*	The outline's chapter map no longer controls (TCD-002)
FTE	*FTE Official Beta Reader Copy*, through ch. 29	Chapter 29 fragment and chs. 31–39 (rewrite required); *The Challenges FTE Year*; *49th Chess Tournament Placements*	Every pre-Beta generation is Legacy (TCD-001)
ADST	*ADST*, 19 chapters	Revised 17-chapter plan; retained climax components from the older 42-chapter plan	The older plan's early execution and ending outcome are superseded (TCD-003, TCD-053)

BOOK	CONTROLS DRAFTED EVENTS	SUPPORTS UNDRAFTED WORK	STATUS OF THE REST
TSWK	No manuscript	*Thalara Worldbuilding*; *Azrine and Levi*; July 2026 44-chapter blueprint, provisional by claim	Ending open (TCD-012)

SOURCE NOTE

The Project copies of several files carry names without the version suffixes the audit used (*3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft* rather than *First Draft(9)*; *ADST* rather than *ADST(3)*). The Companion treats each as the audited generation because its content matches the audit's description. *The Imperial Lineage* appears in the Project but not in the audit inventory, so it holds no assigned authority until it's classified; nothing in Parts I–III relies on it.

Why it matters: most canon errors in a four-book universe aren't invented facts. They're real facts pulled from the wrong generation or the wrong domain. The ladder is how the Companion answers "which file?" before it answers "what's true?"

SOURCE *Audit, Preliminary Domain-Based Source Authority Map; Production Master A2; TCD-001, TCD-002, TCD-003, TCD-010, TCD-012.*

SEE ALSO Appendix C Source Authority Inventory · **p.156**

STATUS KEY · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.4 READING A CLAIM: STATUS MARKERS

Teach the eight markers and the wording each allows.

A status marker attaches to a claim, not to a page. One dossier page can hold settled canon, a drafted fact, a plan, and an open question side by side, and each keeps its own label. The marker also controls the grammar. A ◌ POSSIBLE claim written in confident present tense is a canon error even with the ◌ POSSIBLE sitting next to it, because readers believe sentences before they believe badges.

STATUS KEY

MARKER	MEANING	PERMITTED WORDING	FORBIDDEN WORDING
● CANON	Established by an author ruling or a controlling source in its domain	Plain declarative present tense, with the TCD or source cited	Hedging that makes settled canon look optional
■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT	Established on-page in the controlling manuscript generation	"On-page, ..." · "As drafted, ..." · "In ch. 7, ..."	Treating it as immune to revision
◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL	A current plan, bible, blueprint, or artifact that hasn't become drafted canon	"The outline plans..." · "The blueprint proposes..." · "The worldbuilding file describes..."	Present-tense narration of events as though they happened
◌ POSSIBLE	A live candidate or recovery idea, not approved	"A candidate is..." · "One viable reading..." · "If recovered, ..."	"Is," "will," or "does" about the story world
○ OPEN	Unresolved; an author decision is needed if and when drafting forces it	State what's fixed, then name exactly what isn't	Filling the gap with a plausible answer
◇ CONFLICT	Current sources disagree and no ruling settles it	Name both sources and both claims	Picking the nicer version silently

I.4 · READING A CLAIM: STATUS MARKERS

CONTINUED

MARKER	MEANING	PERMITTED WORDING	FORBIDDEN WORDING
☐ RESEARCH	Needs outside factual research	State the research question	Presenting a guess as fact
~~LEGACY / SUPERSEDED~~	Creative history that no longer controls	Past tense, source named: "The 2025 FINAL had…"	Using it to answer a current question

HOW TO READ A CLAIM: SIX WORKED EXAMPLES

CLAIM AS PRINTED	STATUS	WHY IT'S LABELED THIS WAY
Katherine Nicholas is the current Tournament's Conqueror.	● CANON · TCD-034	An author ruling fixes it, so it takes plain present tense even though the scene that earns it isn't drafted yet. The ruling controls the outcome; the manuscript still has to build the causal path.
On-page, Katherine's Examination puts her through severe Fire trauma and still produces only Frost.	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT · FTE Beta; TCD-058	The Beta shows it. TCD-058 later explains why it happens (dominant Frost configuration, no ordinary stress trigger), but the event itself is anchored in drafted prose.
The July 2026 blueprint plans Azrine's ordination near the end of Book One.	◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL · blueprint, per audit HC-061	The most detailed TSWK plan proposes it. No ruling has adopted it, so it's written as a plan, never as "Azrine is ordained."
The Conduit Trials' final canon name hasn't been chosen.	○ OPEN · TCD-008	The concept and mechanics are current. The name is a working title, and every page that uses it flags it.
The blueprint's chapter 29 credits "Cael Dren" with designing the sacrificial route and First Anchor, while its chapters 38–39 identify twelve-year-old Caelen as the first sacrificed Anchor.	◇ CONFLICT · HC-059	Two passages in one plan disagree. The Companion names both and protects TCD-064's twelve-year-old Caelen without deciding who designed the route.

CLAIM AS PRINTED	STATUS	WHY IT'S LABELED THIS WAY
The 2025-era lore treated the Echo Gate as the singular sealed crossing between Remnia and Somnoria.	~~LEGACY / SUPERSEDED~~ · TCD-027	Past tense, source named. Its seal, spiral or mirrored glyph, and ancient-crossing imagery may come back only as ◌ POSSIBLE.

☐ RESEARCH appears when a scene needs real-world fact the sources can't supply. The clearest current case is the Remy death scene: once the weapon and wound are chosen, the blood-loss timing Melena works against is a research question, not a canon question (TCD-063 leaves weapon and anatomy open).

PAGE FURNITURE YOU'LL SEE THROUGHOUT

- *Source* — lines close each section. They're margin provenance in the manuscript and become small-type margin notes in layout.
- **GUARDRAIL** boxes hold locked constraints a drafter could break without noticing.
- **NOT THE SAME AS** callouts separate paired terms readers merge.
- **OPEN DEVELOPMENT** boxes carry four lines: Fixed / Undecided / Why it matters / Decide by.
- **TANDEM CANON DECISION** blocks appear only where a page genuinely can't proceed.
- **See also** lines point to related sections by number.

Why it matters: the status system is the reason this book can be trusted at 2 a.m. in the middle of a chapter. If a claim has no marker and no qualifying grammar, you're meant to be able to rely on it without checking.

SOURCE *Production Master A3, V6; TCD-008, TCD-027, TCD-034, TCD-058, TCD-063, TCD-064; Audit HC-059, HC-061.*

SEE ALSO Appendix A Canon Decision Log · **p.129** | Appendix E Terminology Register · **p.158**

EXPLAINER · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.5 KNOWLEDGE STATES

Prevent backward knowledge promotion.

No later revelation travels backward into an earlier head. That sounds obvious until the fourth book is drafted and a character in the first one starts making choices that only make sense if she's read the Canon Decision Log. The Companion prevents that by keeping seven lanes of knowledge apart wherever a secret, identity, reveal, or piece of history is involved.

THE SEVEN LANES

LANE	WHAT IT RECORDS	EXAMPLE OF THE LANE IN USE
Objective truth	What is true in the universe	The gang leader's wound kills Remy (TCD-063).
Author knowledge	What Danyelle has ruled or knows, whether or not anyone on-page does	Katherine and Melena are paternal half-sisters through Tobias (TCD-040), long before either sister proves it.
Reader knowledge	What a reader knows at a specific point in a specific book	Tracked per chapter in each book's knowledge ledger; never assumed from author knowledge.
Character knowledge	What a named character knows, and from when	Melena enters the Challenge Six Duel with substantial suspicion about Katherine and no proof (TCD-050).
Character belief	What a character thinks is true when it's wrong or incomplete	Early Reverie believes she's an illegal, unlicensed Dreamwalker with a rare gift; she's also a natural conduit (TCD-029).
Institutional / public version	What Houses, the Sanctum, the Synod, Skyhold, schools, or governments teach or record	The Sanctum's likely "Dyad" label for Katherine, which is incomplete (TCD-049).
Suppressed / rewritten	What's sealed, censored, misfiled, mythologized, redacted, or lost	House Dren's willing-adult First Anchor mythology versus twelve-year-old Caelen (TCD-064).

The six levels of cross-land knowledge. Knowing another land exists doesn't mean knowing where it is, how its magic works, how to reach it, what its history is, or how the four lands actually relate. TCD-016 separates these into six levels, and none implies another:

1. **Existence** — the land is real.
2. **Location** — where it is.
3. **Functional** — how its people, magic, or institutions work.
4. **Route** — how to get there.
5. **Historical** — what happened between the lands.
6. **True Tandem knowledge** — the objective relationship among all four.

A drafted 3SL example shows why the ladder matters. In chapter 11, Remy jokes that the only place Melena can't reach the blackroot is Somnoria, and Silas hopes she won't ask what Somnoria is. On-page, that establishes that both men know Somnoria by name. It doesn't establish that either knows where it is, how to get there, or anything about dream magic. In chapter 3, Silas reads Melena's fire as proof she's Remnian because "fire belonged to Remnia." That's functional knowledge about one feature of Remnian magic, held as Silas's belief, and it says nothing about what the Synod teaches or what Silas knows of Remnian history.
■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (3SL chs. 3, 11).

Worked example: two clocks for one missing man. Elias Lockwood and Professor Alexander Thorne are one person with two public lives, and the two lives go missing on different schedules.

LANE	ELIAS LOCKWOOD / PROFESSOR ALEXANDER THORNE	STATUS
Objective truth	Elias voluntarily created and maintained Thorne as an established Somnorian researcher and instructor for years. The Nightmare organization targets Thorne's boundary/Network research and exploits the vulnerability it creates, compromising his dream and magical functioning so that ordinary return to Remnia becomes unsafe or impossible.	● CANON TCD-032, TCD-062
Author knowledge	The failure-to-return cause is fixed. The exact compromise technique, first crossing, alias credentials, helpers, later captivity, and physical status are not.	○ OPEN
Institutional / public version, Remnia	Remnia notices Elias missing first, because he fails to return on pattern.	● CANON TCD-062

LANE	ELIAS LOCKWOOD / PROFESSOR ALEXANDER THORNE	STATUS
Institutional / public version, Somnoria	Thorne initially remains publicly present but deteriorating; his Somnorian disappearance comes later.	● **CANON** TCD-062
Character belief	Breakdown rumors circulate in Somnoria. They reflect a real, patterned compromise, not the whole truth.	● **CANON** TCD-062
Character knowledge	Reverie encounters Thorne's collapsing dream. Whether and when she learns Thorne is Elias isn't established here.	Encounter ● **CANON** TCD-062; identity knowledge ○ **OPEN**
Reader knowledge	Set chapter by chapter in the ADST and FTE knowledge ledgers (V.16†, IV.22†).	Tracked, not assumed

Why it matters: the two clocks are the whole trick of this plotline. Remnia is already searching while Somnoria still sees Thorne teaching. Collapse the lanes and one country reacts to news it hasn't received.

GUARDRAIL

In-world language survives as perspective, never as cosmology. A Somnorian calling Remnia "another world" is Somnorian framing (TCD-015). House Aether calling the Prism a "cage" is House Aether's interpretation (TCD-038). Caelum calling Melena his "asset" is Caelum's framing (TCD-043).

SOURCE *TCD-015, TCD-016, TCD-029, TCD-032, TCD-038, TCD-040, TCD-043, TCD-049, TCD-050, TCD-062, TCD-063, TCD-064; Production Master A5; 3SL draft chs. 3, 11.*

SEE ALSO II.4 Knowledge of the Other Lands · **p.31**

VII.5 Cross-Land Knowledge Matrix → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

VII.10 Continuity Translation Pages → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

PROTOCOL · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.6 OPEN CANON, DECISIONS, AND UPDATES

Show how open material is displayed and how rulings enter the book.

Open stays open. The Companion doesn't close a question because a page looks unfinished with it, and it doesn't ask for a ruling just because the book reached that topic. It asks only when a page, a scene, or a publication-level commitment can't be written accurately without an answer.

The OPEN DEVELOPMENT box. Wherever an open point sits beside settled canon, it gets a four-line box. Here's a live one, reproduced from Part II:

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE REMNIA–UNDERSIDE CROSSING · ○ OPEN

FIXED	UNDECIDED
A current crossing exists near the London Town edge, in the no-man's-land associated with London Town, Old Prosperity, and Alea. It's physical-magical transit, not a portal. The singular Echo Gate is Legacy. (TCD-017, TCD-027)	Its precise map coordinate, and whether it arrives directly in Shadowmere, Tier 7.
WHY IT MATTERS	**DECIDE BY**
Arrival tier decides who controls the Underside end, who can trace a crossing, and how Melena's route from Remnia into Shadowmere reads on-page.	When Danyelle's Remnia map is reviewed, or earlier if a 3SL scene has to show the arrival point.

The "Decide by" line is the useful one. It names the actual drafting moment that forces the answer. If nothing forces it, the line says "safe to defer," and that's a complete answer.

The TANDEM CANON DECISION block. When a page truly can't proceed, the Companion uses this format and nothing looser: the exact issue, the sources creating it, options A through D where the evidence offers them, E for "Something else / I want to explain," one line of implication under each option, and a labeled recommendation only when the evidence strongly favors one path. No more than five at once; one to three is better. A recommendation is never canon until ruled.

TANDEM CANON DECISION — SPECIMEN (FORMAT ONLY; NOT ASKED NOW)

Issue: Who designed First Shellward's sacrificial route and First Anchor?

Sources: July 2026 TSWK blueprint ch. 29 ("Cael Dren" as designer) versus chs. 38–39 (twelve-year-old Caelen as first sacrificed Anchor); TCD-064.

A. Forged credit. House record credits a figure who didn't design it. *Implication:* the tablet becomes evidence of rewritten history.

B. Distinct adult designer. Cael Dren and Caelen are different people. *Implication:* two names need separate provenance.

C. Drafting error. The blueprint conflated names. *Implication:* one passage is corrected; no in-world lie.

E. Something else / I want to explain.

Recommendation: None. The evidence doesn't strongly favor one option, and HC-059 is deferred to the TSWK draft.

How a ruling enters the book. When a new ruling lands or drafted prose deliberately changes something:

1. Log it in the Canon Decision Log with its date, what it supersedes, and its downstream implications.
2. Update the High-Impact Conflict Register if it resolves or opens a conflict.
3. Update every Companion page listed in the ruling's affected-sections field.
4. Move superseded claims to the Legacy Recovery Index rather than deleting them.
5. Re-run the integrity checks on every touched page: no Legacy claim presented as canon, no ◌ POSSIBLE or ◩ SUPPORTED claim in declarative story-world tense, no conflict silently harmonized, no knowledge promoted backward, no symmetry assumed across the four lands, no duplicate or contradictory table, no invented canon, no open question phrased as settled, no TKC content imported.

GUARDRAIL

Asking a question assigns no TCD number. The audit's proposed TCD-065 through TCD-074 were never answered or adopted, so none of them is canon and none of those numbers is reserved.

I.6 · OPEN CANON, DECISIONS, AND UPDATES

CONTINUED

Why it matters: an open question that's clearly marked is safe to draft around. An open question that's been quietly answered by whoever wrote the page last is how three versions of the same backstory end up in print.

SOURCE *Production Master A8–A10, A12; Audit, Architecture Handoff; TCD-017, TCD-027, TCD-064; Audit HC-059.*

SEE ALSO VII.12 Open Canon Queue → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

Appendix A Canon Decision Log · **p.129** | Appendix B High-Impact Conflict Register · **p.152**

CHECKLIST · PART I · HOW THIS COMPANION WORKS

I.7 USING THE COMPANION WHILE DRAFTING

Make the book fast to use mid-scene.

Start with the book's draft-forward packet, not the front of the Companion. Each dossier ends with pages built to sit open beside the manuscript: III.19 for 3SL, IV.24† for FTE, V.17† for ADST, VI.13† for TSWK. They condense the locked beats, the current knowledge states, and the scene-level open choices, and they cross-reference the full sections behind them.

BEFORE A SCENE

- [ ] Check the packet for any GUARDRAIL that touches the characters or magic in the scene.
- [ ] Check the knowledge ledger for what each POV character knows *at this chapter*, not at the end of the book.
- [ ] Check whether the scene touches a ● CANON ruling. If it does, the outcome is fixed and the scene's job is to earn it.
- [ ] Check whether the scene touches an ○ OPEN item. If the open item doesn't affect this scene, keep drafting.

WHILE DRAFTING

- An open question that doesn't touch the next scene doesn't stop the next scene.
- If the scene needs an answer to an open item, make the choice in prose and flag it. You don't need a ruling first; you need a record afterward.
- If the scene seems to need something that contradicts a ruling, stop. That's the one case where the draft waits.
- Don't pull a fact from a Legacy file to fill a gap, however well it fits. Check the Legacy Recovery Index; if the idea is listed there as recoverable, it comes back as ◌ POSSIBLE and gets ruled on like anything new.

AFTER THE SCENE

- [ ] If the prose settled an open item on purpose, log it through the update protocol (I.6).
- [ ] If the prose changed a knowledge state, update the book's knowledge ledger.
- [ ] If the prose introduced a new name, place, route, or rule, add it to the relevant dossier with its chapter as provenance.

Navigation conventions. Sections are numbered Part.section (III.8, VII.5), so insertions don't renumber the book. "See also" lines at each section's foot point outward. Rulings are cited by TCD number, conflicts by HC number, and manuscript facts by book and chapter.

Why it matters: the Companion should cost you seconds mid-scene, not an evening. If using it slows drafting down more than it protects the draft, the page is built wrong, and that's a Companion problem to fix.

SOURCE *Production Master I.7, A8; Audit, Architecture Handoff.*

SEE ALSO III.19 3SL Draft-Forward Packet · **p.104** | IV.24 FTE Endgame Packet † | V.17 ADST Climax Packet † | VI.13 TSWK Blueprint-to-Rulings Reconciliation Packet †

PART II · BUILD 1

II THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

This is what holds across all four books before any single story gets its own dossier. Nearly all of it comes straight from author rulings, which is why it can be written with confidence now. Its open slots are mostly cartographic and deep-historical: the Companion knows how the lands relate and how the ancient break worked in outline, and it doesn't yet know coastlines, dates, or the rupture's actual cause.

§	SECTION	PAGE TYPE	PAGE
II.2	Macro Geography	SCHEMATIC	27
II.3	Routes and Cross-Land Transit	EXPLAINER	29
II.4	Knowledge of the Other Lands	EXPLAINER · LADDER	31
II.5	Shared Magical Ancestry	EXPLAINER · TABLE	34
II.14	The Elders' Prayer	EXPLAINER · CAN/CANNOT	37
II.16	Shared Chronology	TIMELINE	40

This volume prints the Part II sections a 3SL scene stands on. II.1, II.6–II.13, and II.15 are in the full Tandem Companion.

GUARDRAIL

No symmetry assumed across the four lands.

SCHEMATIC · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.2 MACRO GEOGRAPHY

Place the lands relative to each other without inventing cartography.

The four lands occupy multiple major landmasses and regions in one world. ● CANON TCD-025. Four placements are fixed:

- **Remnia and Somnoria** are separate continental landmasses with ocean between them.
- **The Underside** attaches to the Zenithia side, or corner, of Remnia's broader geography and descends from there. ● CANON TCD-025, TCD-026
- **Thalara**, primarily underwater, lies farther outward in the island and sea region.
- **Relative position** is described by a Spain / France / Italy / Greek-islands comparison. That comparison controls relative placement only.

GUARDRAIL

What the analogy does not mean.

It doesn't import real borders, coastlines, scale, distances, climate, culture, languages, or history. It doesn't make any land a disguised version of a real country. It doesn't settle which way anything faces on a map. It tells you roughly where the lands sit in relation to one another, and nothing more.

The Underside's placement deserves its own sentence because it's the easiest to get wrong. It isn't a buried continent lying flat beneath Remnia. It's a vertically tiered nation that begins at or near the surface off Zenithia's side and descends. Its top tiers, Crownlight and Dawnveil, are above ground; by Ironcross the descent is fully subterranean. ● CANON TCD-026. Part III builds the full cross-section.

Schematic, not a map. Until Danyelle's canonical Remnia map is reviewed, the Companion uses a relative-position schematic: two continental masses separated by ocean, the Underside marked as a descending column off one side of Remnia near Zenithia, and Thalara marked as a sea region farther out with its territory below the surface. The schematic carries no coastlines, scale bar, compass rose, or place names beyond these.

SCHEMATIC · PLACEHOLDER

Relative-position schematic pending review of Danyelle's canonical Remnia map.
No coastlines, scale, compass, or place names are drawn in this volume.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · MACRO CARTOGRAPHY · ○ OPEN

FIXED
One world; the four placements above; the Underside's vertical attachment off Zenithia's side (TCD-015, TCD-025, TCD-026).

UNDECIDED
Coastlines, names of landmasses and oceans, scale, distances, islands, and borders. Zenithia's exact political classification is confirmed against the Remnian province index in Part IV† rather than assumed here.

WHY IT MATTERS
Distance sets travel time, and travel time sets how long news takes to cross (VII.2).

DECIDE BY
Remnia layer when the Remnia map is reviewed; other layers safe to defer until a scene needs a distance.

Why it matters: geography is where cross-book continuity breaks quietly. A character who reaches Somnoria "by nightfall" has just committed the Companion to a distance, whether anyone meant to.

SOURCE *TCD-015, TCD-025, TCD-026. Record: Tandem Macro Geography Map (schematic stage).*

SEE ALSO III.3 The Underside: A Vertical Nation · **p.49** | IV.2 Remnia at a Glance † | VI.2 Thalara at a Glance †

EXPLAINER · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.3 ROUTES AND CROSS-LAND TRANSIT

Define movement without portal logic.

Routes are magically enabled transit through real physical passages. ● CANON TCD-017. A route may cross a barrier, collapse distance, or reach concealed geography, but it never crosses into another dimension. And not every route can do every thing: a route's scale and capability have to be established one route at a time.

Working route classes. The audit sets six working classes. The taxonomy is ◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL, a tool for sorting rather than a ruling that every route must fit one box.

CLASS	WHAT IT'S FOR	CROSS-LAND?
Local	Movement within one area or settlement	No, by definition
Tier	Movement between vertical levels (the Underside's tiers are the clearest case)	No, unless separately established
Restricted / Institutional	Passages controlled by an authority and opened by permission	Only if individually established
Underground / Smuggling	Unsanctioned passages used to move people or goods around authority	Only if individually established
Boundary	Passages that breach barriers between lands	Yes, by definition
Neutral Transit	Passages whose control is shared or held by a third party	Only if individually established

Every route entry tracks the same fields: origin, controller, who knows of it, opening requirements, stability, destination, cost and risk, traceability, what travelers know, and alternate names. ● CANON TCD-017.

THE ONE CONFIRMED CROSS-LAND CROSSING

FIELD	REMNIA–UNDERSIDE CROSSING
Status	● CANON exists · TCD-027

FIELD	REMNIA–UNDERSIDE CROSSING
Location	Near the London Town edge, in the no-man's-land associated with London Town, Old Prosperity, and Alea
Class	Boundary (it connects Remnia and the Underside)
Nature	Physical-magical transit, not a portal
Precise coordinate	○ **OPEN** · controlled by the canonical Remnia map once reviewed
Arrival tier	○ **OPEN** · Shadowmere, Tier 7, is unconfirmed
Controller, access, cost, traceability	○ **OPEN**
Alternate names	None established

NOT THE SAME AS

The Echo Gate is not this crossing. The singular sealed Echo Gate between Remnia and Somnoria is ~~LEGACY / SUPERSEDED~~. Its seal, its spiral or mirrored glyph, and its ancient-crossing imagery may be recovered later only as ◌ **POSSIBLE**. ● **CANON** TCD-027

Why it matters: route logic decides who can show up where, how fast, and who'll know. Treat a route like a portal and every border in the series stops mattering; treat every route as able to reach every land and the isolation that makes the lands feel like separate worlds collapses.

SOURCE *TCD-017, TCD-027; Production Master II.3. Record: Route Classification System (taxonomy provisional).*

SEE ALSO III.6 Routes in the Underside and the Remnian Crossing · **p.60**

VII.4 Route and Transit Timeline → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

EXPLAINER · LADDER · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.4 KNOWLEDGE OF THE OTHER LANDS

Kill universal-awareness shortcuts.

There's no universal answer to "do people know about the other lands?" Awareness varies by nation, class, institution, profession, network, person, and time. ● CANON TCD-016. A smuggler, a Sanctum archivist, and a miner's kid in the same land can hold three different pictures, and all three can change between chapter 5 and chapter 25.

The six levels from I.5 do the sorting: existence, location, functional, route, historical, and true Tandem knowledge. None implies another. Someone can know Somnoria's name and nothing about where it is. Someone can use a route without knowing what's on the far side of the boundary it crosses. Someone can know a land's history as their own institution teaches it, which may be the least reliable version available.

Four kinds of source feed a character's picture, and the Companion tracks them separately: what their institution teaches or officially claims, what their network passes around as rumor or trade knowledge, what's been suppressed or rewritten, and what they've learned firsthand. An error counts as knowledge for drafting purposes. A character acts on what she believes, and the Companion records the belief with its lane label.

What the drafted pages already establish. These are seed entries for the full matrix in VII.5. Every row is dated to its chapter; none is a claim about what the character's whole society knows.

CHARACTER	CHAPTER	KNOWLEDGE ON-PAGE	LEVEL	STATUS
Silas Graves	3SL ch. 3	Reads Melena's fire as proof she's Remnian; believes nobody born in the Underside carries fire	Functional (as belief)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Silas Graves	3SL ch. 11	Knows Somnoria by name; hopes Melena won't ask what it is	Existence	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

CHARACTER	CHAPTER	KNOWLEDGE ON-PAGE	LEVEL	STATUS
Remy	3SL ch. 11	Names Somnoria in a joke about distance	Existence; the joke implies he thinks it's far	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Dante Mercer	3SL ch. 3	Knows Melena is Remnia's Imperial Princess and Lucia's daughter; expects Remnia to treat her discovery as an act of war	Functional (Remnian politics); historical (personal, through Lucia)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Mother Rae (Maven Renae Vellum)	3SL chs. 3, 11	Knew Lucia; Lucia's final letter gave Melena Rae's name and a route phrase that should've been dead twenty years	Route (at least one route phrase)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Caelum	Series-level	Deep access to Nightmare-adjacent information, people, routes, and markets across lands	Varies by domain; not omniscient	● CANON TCD-031
Elias Lockwood	Series-level	Knows both Remnia and Somnoria from inside, having lived as Professor Alexander Thorne for years	Location, route, functional (personal)	● CANON TCD-032

GUARDRAIL

One character's knowledge never becomes their land's knowledge. Dante knowing Remnian politics says nothing about what the Synod teaches, and the Synod's teaching says nothing about what Gutterlight knows.

Why it matters: cross-land knowledge is the series' pressure valve. When isolation holds, each book can stay intimate and local. When knowledge starts leaking, the leak itself is plot, and it only reads as plot if the Companion knows exactly who knew what before.

SOURCE *TCD-016, TCD-031, TCD-032; 3SL draft chs. 3, 11. Record: Knowledge of the Other Lands Matrix (seeded).*

II.4 · KNOWLEDGE OF THE OTHER LANDS

CONTINUED

SEE ALSO I.5 Knowledge States · **p.18**

VII.2 Event Chronology vs Information Chronology → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

VII.5 Cross-Land Knowledge Matrix → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

EXPLAINER · TABLE · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.5 SHARED MAGICAL ANCESTRY

Explain shared deep origin without making magics interchangeable.

All four modern magical traditions ultimately draw from one primordial magical source or substrate that predates the modern division of the Tandem world. ● CANON TCD-035. The Divide didn't create four unrelated magics. Geography, environment, bodies, bloodlines, culture, survival, history, and institutions reshaped one shared power into systems that are now genuinely distinct, with their own access, costs, classifications, and cultural explanations.

Both halves of that ruling carry weight. The shared root means cross-land resonance is possible without anyone inventing a coincidence. The genuine distinctness means a Somnorian dream technique doesn't work in Remnia just because both descend from the same source, and a Thalaran seal cadence isn't a Silencecraft seal with a different accent. Long isolation after the Divide accelerated the specialization. ● CANON TCD-045

THE FOUR MODERN BRANCHES

LAND	MODERN BRANCH	KNOWN PRACTICES AND TERMS	WHO CLASSIFIES IT	FALSE EQUIVALENCE TO AVOID
The Underside	Life, death, grief, and memory magic, formally organized as the Six Disciplines	Thanomancy, Lamentcraft, Silencecraft, Underchant Cant, Funereal Engineering, Mycelial Memory (◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL, *3SL Full Worldbuilding*). On-page: Silencecraft and Silence seals, Quietcasters, Shrouds, funeral and grief thread, Hush, Underchant markings (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, 3SL chs. 1–12). **Graveshand** is inherited Graves-family magic outside the Six Disciplines. ● CANON TCD-004	The Synod regulates and enforces (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)	Graveshand is not a seventh Discipline.

LAND	MODERN BRANCH	KNOWN PRACTICES AND TERMS	WHO CLASSIFIES IT	FALSE EQUIVALENCE TO AVOID
Remnia	Elemental magic	Fire and Frost confirmed on-page; the full elemental roster is confirmed against *FTE Elemental Factions* in Part IV†. Modern Dyads exist; Zephyr is a genuine Fire/Frost Dyad. ● CANON TCD-049	The Sanctum, within its semi-autonomous magical-regulation domain. ● CANON TCD-041	Katherine is not Zephyr's kind of Dyad (TCD-049, TCD-058).
Somnoria	Dream magic	Dreamwalking, licensing, Remote Viewing, natural conduits, the Dream Network. ● CANON TCD-029	The Dream Master's Guild regulates professional dream practice. ● CANON TCD-021	Somnoria's Network uses of the Oneiros Prism are not the Prism's original purpose (TCD-019).
Thalara	Seamwork and the Seal Song	The Seal Song works through breath and resonance; its components include the Breathline, the Anchor Verse, and the Seal Cadence; Sealhands and Seamworkers operate it (◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL, *Thalara Worldbuilding*)	Skyhold controls the sanctioned version and censors others (◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL)	The Seal Song is not the Drowned Canticle (TCD-028). Dren compatibility is not Leviathan identity (TCD-064).

NOT THE SAME AS

repeated nouns across branches.

Several words recur across the four magics, and none of them proves a shared mechanism. "Tether" names Silas and Isola's involuntary bond, the death tethers the Pit Wardens search for, and the tether-lines Silencecraft's Severing cuts. "Anchor" names Thalara's Anchor Verse, House Dren's Anchor program, and the ADST organization's living conduit/anchor configuration. "Severing" in the Silencecraft section of the worldbuilding and Graveshand Severance in 3SL are separate things until a source joins them. Each term is defined inside its own branch.

Resemblance isn't inheritance. The Underside treats memory as currency and names as anchors; Thalara's sea began holding memory after the Drowning, and shells hold impressions. The rhyme is real on the page. It isn't evidence of a shared mechanism, a shared origin event, or a transfer between lands. ● CANON Production Master A6

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE PRIMORDIAL LAYER · ○ OPEN

FIXED	UNDECIDED
One shared substrate; four genuinely distinct modern branches; isolation after the Divide accelerated specialization (TCD-035, TCD-045).	What the substrate was, how it was used before the Divide, the mechanism of divergence, which old principles survive in which branch, how branches interact when they meet, and which culture's theory of magic is most historically accurate.
WHY IT MATTERS	**DECIDE BY**
Katherine's ancestral reversion (TCD-049) and every future cross-branch encounter lean on this layer.	Safe to defer until a scene has to explain a cross-branch interaction rather than just show one.

Why it matters: shared ancestry gives the series its deep logic, and false equivalence is the fastest way to ruin it. When two lands' magics meet on-page, the scene should feel like two dialects of a lost language, mutually strange, not two brands of the same tool.

SOURCE *TCD-004, TCD-019, TCD-021, TCD-028, TCD-029, TCD-035, TCD-041, TCD-045, TCD-049, TCD-058, TCD-064;* 3SL Full Worldbuilding *(Six Disciplines);* Thalara Worldbuilding *(Seal Song structure); 3SL draft chs. 1–12. Record: Tandem Magic Ancestry Map.*

SEE ALSO II.6 Crossblood: A Label, Not a Biology † · III.7 The Six Disciplines · **p.65** · III.8 Graveshand, Deathwork, and Severance · **p.67** · IV.5 Elemental Magic † · V.4 Dream Magic and the Dream Network † · VI.3 The Seal Song and the Drowned Canticle †

EXPLAINER · CAN/CANNOT · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.14 THE ELDERS' PRAYER

Define one inherited working across cultures.

The Elders' Prayer is one inherited magical working that survives in more than one culture under different language and ritual expression. ● CANON TCD-023. Its objective function is specific: it restores a living person's viable magical and life pattern when that pattern has been severed, corrupted, or catastrophically dysregulated. ● CANON TCD-057. Restored magical continuity can stabilize secondary bodily functions and call someone back from active dying, as long as a viable living pattern remains.

It has hard edges. It can't resurrect completed death. It can't regenerate destroyed anatomy. ● CANON TCD-057

WHAT THE PRAYER CAN AND CAN'T DO

CAN	CAN'T
Restore a viable living magical/life pattern that's been severed, corrupted, or catastrophically dysregulated	Resurrect someone whose death is complete
Stabilize secondary bodily functions when magical disruption is causal	Regenerate destroyed anatomy. Isola's leg remains ruined despite life-saving stabilization.
Call someone back from active dying while a viable pattern remains	Redistribute a burden automatically and universally from one person to another
Work through different cultural presentations with the same objective function	Serve as a Frost-only ritual

Two performances, about two years apart. Selah and Katherine perform the same inherited working independently, roughly two years apart. ● CANON TCD-048

	SELAH WRAITHMOOR	KATHERINE NICHOLAS
Book	3SL	FTE
Recipients	Silas and Isola	Atlas
Cultural form	Underside presentation	Remnian presentation

	SELAH WRAITHMOOR	KATHERINE NICHOLAS
Ruled outcome	Silas's returning breath and pulse is recovery of living function, not resurrection. Isola's leg stays ruined.	Effects on Atlas, and on Melena, remain open.
Drafting state	Performance record confirmed against the 3SL draft in III.16	Undrafted in the controlling generation; a rewrite-required candidate exists in Chapter 29.docx (IV.17)
Governing rulings	● CANON TCD-048, TCD-057	● CANON TCD-009, TCD-048, TCD-057

GUARDRAIL

No echo.

Selah's act leaves no specific echo, reservoir, transmitted route, or power that Katherine later accesses. The two performances are connected by shared magical ancestry and ritual tradition, not by causation. Katherine doesn't need to know Selah exists, or that the Prayer has an Underside form, or its history. (TCD-023, TCD-048)

NOT THE SAME AS

Selah's cold, which the 3SL draft shows fogging metal and spreading frost across a table (chs. 2, 6, 12), isn't evidence that the Prayer is a Frost working or that Selah and Katherine share an elemental affinity. The Frost-only reading of the ritual is superseded (TCD-057). Similar imagery isn't evidence.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE PRAYER'S MECHANICS · ○ OPEN

FIXED

Objective function; the death boundary; the anatomy boundary; two independent performances; no direct causation (TCD-023, TCD-048, TCD-057).

UNDECIDED

Eligibility; what serves as the original-pattern reference; whether a bond or physical contact is required; the exact death threshold; the caster's cost; the transmission history; whether and how the working survives in Somnoria and Thalara; who recognizes it across cultures.

WHY IT MATTERS

Katherine's performance for Atlas has to obey the same limits Selah's did. If Atlas's injury has already destroyed anatomy, the Prayer can stabilize him but can't make him whole.

DECIDE BY

Before the FTE endgame drafts Katherine's performance; caster cost before either performance is revised.

II.14 · THE ELDERS' PRAYER

CONTINUED

SOURCE *TCD-009, TCD-023, TCD-048, TCD-057; 3SL draft chs. 2, 6, 12 (Selah's cold). Record: Elders' Prayer Transmission + Variant / Functional Anatomy Record (registry in VII.7).*

SEE ALSO

III.16 Selah and the Elders' Prayer in 3SL · **p.97**

IV.17 The Elders' Prayer in FTE → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

VII.7 Repeated Working and Ritual Registry → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

TIMELINE · PART II · THE SHARED TANDEM SPINE

II.16 SHARED CHRONOLOGY

Place the books in time without chapter lockstep.

The books are placed in time by macro windows, not by chapter lockstep. ● CANON TCD-013. 3SL happens about two years before the main concurrent period. ADST begins when Elias goes missing, and FTE begins a couple of weeks later. The two then run largely concurrently and end around the same time, without requiring their chapters to line up one for one.

TSWK and the next Shadowmere installment form the next concurrent window. They begin directly after FTE and ADST, with no meaningful gap of months or years; a few days or small weeks for logistics are fine. They overlap each other substantially without needing identical opening dates. ● CANON TCD-014, TCD-024, TCD-054. The handoff is rolling: conditions for the later plots may already be active during late FTE and ADST, and still-later stories may begin activating before the prior pair fully resolves.

Four bands per book. Every book is tracked by four separate dates, because "when does it happen?" has four answers.

BOOK	BACKGROUND ACTIVATION	NARRATIVE OPENING	CLIMAX	RESOLUTION
3SL	○ OPEN	About two years before the FTE/ADST window; exact date ○ OPEN	Remy's death and Melena's catastrophic Fire; Tiran's cleanup follows (TCD-002, TCD-063)	Silas and Isola on separate immediate paths (TCD-044)
ADST	Elias's years-long double life as Thorne; the organization's compromise of his research and dream functioning (TCD-032, TCD-062)	When Elias goes missing (TCD-013)	The Nightmare organization's attempted Network rupture; the first established Convergence threshold, T0 (TCD-056, TCD-060)	Around the same time as FTE's (TCD-013)
FTE	○ OPEN beyond the 3SL aftermath and the Elias clock	A couple of weeks after ADST opens (TCD-013)	Challenge Six; the London Town forfeit (TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-052)	Around the same time as ADST's (TCD-013)

II.16 · SHARED CHRONOLOGY

CONTINUED

BOOK	BACKGROUND ACTIVATION	NARRATIVE OPENING	CLIMAX	RESOLUTION
TSWK	May predate page one: the crackdown, Azrine's sanctuary, Levi's assignment (TCD-054)	Directly after FTE/ADST; days or small weeks (TCD-054)	○ OPEN (TCD-012)	○ OPEN (TCD-012)
Next Shadowmere book	May predate page one, including its character's continuing two-year life (TCD-054)	Directly after FTE/ADST; overlaps TSWK substantially (TCD-054)	○ OPEN	○ OPEN

GUARDRAIL

Temporal proximity isn't causation. Books that overlap in time don't cause each other's events unless a source says so. Local conflicts in TSWK and the next Shadowmere book stay independently rooted (TCD-054).

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE CALENDAR · ○ OPEN

FIXED
The macro windows, the two-year interval, the FTE/ADST sequence, the direct rolling handoff, the Shadowmere 3 / 5 / 7 numbering pattern (TCD-013, TCD-014, TCD-054).

UNDECIDED
A calendar anchor; exact dates in every band; the next Shadowmere installment's title and plot engine; the new canonical Remnian timeline (TCD-010).

WHY IT MATTERS
Information travels at the speed of routes. Without dates, the Companion can't say whether a character could have heard news by a given chapter (VII.2).

DECIDE BY
Remnian timeline before the FTE endgame fixes ages or years; the rest safe to defer until a cross-book appearance needs a date.

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-010, TCD-012, TCD-013, TCD-014, TCD-024, TCD-032, TCD-034, TCD-042, TCD-044, TCD-052, TCD-054, TCD-056, TCD-060, TCD-062, TCD-063. Record: Tandem Master Synchronization Timeline (full grid in VII.1).*

SEE ALSO VII.1 Master Synchronization Timeline → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

VII.2 Event Chronology vs Information Chronology → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

PART III · BUILD 1

III 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

3SL is the book in active drafting, so this is the densest dossier. Everything here exists to make the next 3SL scene safe to write. The draft has twenty-two chapters and a great deal of momentum; the rulings have fixed its climax and its romantic landing; and between the two sits a wide, honest gap that the Companion marks rather than fills.

SOURCE NOTE FOR ALL OF PART III

The *3 Shadowmere Lane Chapter Outline* (the 32-chapter plan) and *Novel Constraints* aren't in this Project. Where Part III refers to the outline, it relies on the audit's record of what the outline fixes (TCD-002, TCD-044, TCD-063), not on the outline itself. The draft was read directly for chs. 1–12 and by targeted passage search for chs. 13–22. Chapter headings confirmed by text are 1–15, 17, 19, and 21; placements in chs. 16, 18, 20, and 22 are by sequence and should be verified in a single full read.

§	SECTION	PAGE TYPE	PAGE
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III.3	The Underside: A Vertical Nation	EXPLAINER · CROSS-SECTION	49
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§	SECTION	PAGE TYPE	PAGE
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STATUS & PROVENANCE SHEET · PART III · 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

III.1 BOOK IDENTITY AND SOURCE STATUS

Tell the drafter which file answers which question.

The draft is the book. ● CANON TCD-002. *3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft*, twenty-two chapters revised through 2026-08-19, controls every drafted event. Beyond chapter 22, only three things are fixed: Remy's death, Tiran's cleanup, and the ruled shape of the Silas/Isola romance. Everything else in the old outline is provisional.

FILE	WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT CONTROLS	WHAT IT CAN'T DO	STATUS
3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft	Manuscript, 22 chapters	On-page chronology, POV, characterization, plot, Graveshand/Deathwork execution	Settle geography or institutions a character only mentions	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
3 Shadowmere Lane Chapter Outline (32 ch.)	Expanded plan	Only the anchors a ruling fixes: Remy's death and Tiran's cleanup (TCD-002); its restrained separation / future-promise ending may survive only after the romance line is crossed (TCD-044)	Map chapters; control any other beat	◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL · **not in this Project**
3SL Character Outlines	Character bible	Histories, relationships, motivations where the draft is silent	Override drafted ages or events; its top-sheet ages describe a later time jump (audit)	◩ SUPPORTED by claim

III.1 · BOOK IDENTITY AND SOURCE STATUS

CONTINUED

FILE	WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT CONTROLS	WHAT IT CAN'T DO	STATUS
3SL Full Worldbuilding	Nine tiers, Synod, culture, economy, the Six Disciplines	Geography, institutions, culture, baseline magic where the draft is silent	Place Graveshand inside the Six Disciplines (TCD-004)	◩ **SUPPORTED**, clarified by TCD-004, TCD-025–026, TCD-035
FTE Official Beta Reader Copy	FTE's controlling manuscript	Melena's FTE memory of Shadowmere	Change the objective 3SL event (TCD-063)	■ **CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT** (FTE domain)

GUARDRAIL

The *Character Outlines* say Remy's death is "directly caused by Melena and her issues." That's emotional framing, not the forensic record. The gang leader kills Remy. (TCD-063)

SOURCE *Audit, 3SL Source Inventory; TCD-002, TCD-004, TCD-044, TCD-063;* 3SL Character Outlines *(Remy entry).*

SEE ALSO Appendix C Source Authority Inventory · **p.156**

III.15 Remy's Death: Beat Sheet and Memory Translation · **p.93**

NOTES · III.1

III.2 CURRENT CANON SNAPSHOT AND STORY ENGINE

What's definitely true at page one and what pressure drives the book.

As drafted, 3SL runs three engines at once and lets them collide. Each started in a different family, and by chapter 22 they've fused into one crisis in one loading cut.

Engine 1 — The princess in the safehouse. Mother Rae brings Melena, Remnia's Imperial Princess and Lucia's daughter, into Dante Mercer's office with no route papers, no belongings, and a sealed letter from her dead mother. Dante assigns Silas to keep her alive and hidden until Rae decides where she goes. Melena's Fire can't be controlled: she burns through a Mercer lock, nearly exposes herself to a Shroud patrol, overdoses on Hush at Blue Circle and sets the den alight, and wrecks the safehouse on blackroot. Remy becomes the one person who can bring her back down. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 3, 5, 7, 11)

Engine 2 — Asha's counterfeit route. Isola finds a counterfeit Veilmark in her cousin Asha's bag. Asha has made six sealed deliveries for Blue Circle, paid on a black route strip with a balance of one hundred eighty Veils and a promise that her name clears when it closes. The coins are high-grade forgeries built to pass upward, bound with the same compound as the stolen Dawnveil token that disappeared Jerrick's runners. Silas verifies the coin at Halflight; the Synod then seals and audits Ashvein's Sixth Ward, strips Micah's Ironcross sponsorship, and orders Asha to explain Blue Circle at third bell. Nobody from the Synod touches Blue Six, the dead box the counterfeit actually moves through. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 2, 6, 8–10, 12–13)

Engine 3 — Silas and Isola. They collide at Pell's stall, meet properly across the Ironcross line at Halflight, and part with Silas's direct route tag, black three, in her coat. When a Shroud lays a death tether in Isola's leg and chases her to Halflight's sealed Ashvein gate, she uses it. Silas opens Graveshand, severs the claim, unmakes the Shroud, breaks the Synod gate, and carries her into Shadowmere. Then, to keep her breathing, he claims her under Graves law and binds her name into his wrist without her consent. The tether that results keeps them both alive and won't let them separate. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 4, 10, 14–18)

Where the draft stops. In the final drafted chapter, Silas and Isola can only move as one body, Isola's leg is braced and ruined, and Synod gold is closing on the Wraithmoor house. Every known route is watched or dead. Remy opens a hidden, blood-keyed passage from the loading cut beneath the block into a station marked NEUTRAL TRANSIT, and he and Melena go through. Silas, Isola, and Rhea can't follow. The wall closes, and the three of them hide in a brake recess as the gold line reaches the place where Remy's blood had been. Remy is alive. The transit route is unresolved. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 22)

What's pulling underneath. The draft has planted four pressures that none of the characters has explained yet. Each is ○ OPEN, and each is load-bearing.

PLANTED PRESSURE	WHAT THE PAGE SHOWS	CHAPTER	STATUS
The Graves mark on the Shroud	The strip across the Shroud's forehead carries a Graves mark cut with the short lower hook Dante wears on every old family threshold	ch. 15	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; meaning ○ OPEN
The shape at the western door	A figure presses through the safehouse's western threshold wearing Dante's shoulders, faceless, with the same short hook across its forehead	chs. 17–18	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; meaning ○ OPEN
The siblings' blood-route	Silas, Jude, and Rhea can hear one another through childhood seals hidden under Camille's ward-clay for nearly twenty years; Dante knows what an opened seal would mean and notices Jude listening	chs. 16–18	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; history ○ OPEN
Remy's route	Remy knows a hidden passage no one else does, keys it with his own blood and the words "Blackwood, Moreno, Aether. Access three, nine, alpha, hollow," and recognizes a green mark above its door	ch. 22	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; meaning ○ OPEN

GUARDRAIL

Three names in Remy's access phrase match surnames the series already uses: Tiran **Blackwood** (FTE), Remy's own full name, Remington Alaric **Moreno** (*Character Outlines*), and House **Aether** (ADST). Repeated nouns aren't shared ontology. Until a ruling connects them, the phrase is a string of words Remy knows, not evidence that Tiran, the Morenos, or House Aether built or control this route.

Divergence from the outline. The audit records that the draft diverges from the 32-chapter outline after the midpoint and that the outline's chapter map no longer controls (TCD-002). Because the outline isn't in this Project, the Companion can't itemize where the two part ways. It doesn't need to: drafted chapters win, and only the three ruled anchors survive from the plan.

Why it matters: 3SL's engines are all route problems wearing different clothes. A princess who crossed seven tiers without papers, a cousin paying for a new name one delivery at a time, and a man who opened a route for the dead to get the woman he wants out alive. The book's climax has to be reached through whatever door Remy just opened.

SOURCE *3SL draft chs. 1–22; TCD-002, TCD-044;* 3SL Character Outlines *(Remy's full name); FTE Beta (Tiran Blackwood).*

SEE ALSO III.6 Routes in the Underside and the Remnian Crossing · p.60

III.17 Plot State and Knowledge Ledger · p.99 III.19 3SL Draft-Forward Packet · p.104

NOTES · III.2

EXPLAINER · CROSS-SECTION · PART III · 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

III.3 THE UNDERSIDE: A VERTICAL NATION

Teach the geography every 3SL scene stands on.

STATUS · AUTHOR RULING 2026-10-09

● CANON	The Underside is vertically tiered and attached to Zenithia's side of Remnia; Crownlight and Dawnveil are surface/above-ground tiers; the nation is fully underground by Ironcross.	TCD-025 · TCD-026
■ DRAFTED	The Underside has nine tiers; Halflight's old route board lists all nine in order.	3SL ch. 10
◪ SUPPORTED	Tier functions and other worldbuilding detail where not independently drafted or ruled.	3SL Full Worldbuilding

The Underside is a vertically tiered nation that begins at or near the surface off Zenithia's side of Remnia and descends. ● CANON TCD-026. Crownlight and Dawnveil are above-ground, surface-level tiers. By Ironcross the descent is fully subterranean, and the lower tiers go deeper still. "Underside" names a civilization organized by descent, even though its highest tiers aren't literally underground.

The draft teaches the order the way the Underside teaches its children. Halflight's old route board lists all nine tiers, one beneath the next, and Isola notes that children learn the order before they learn to cross a street: Crownlight nearest the surface, where the Synod makes laws for places its officials rarely enter; Dawnveil keeping the people rich enough to benefit from them; Ironcross turning both into contracts; everything beneath them supplying what the upper tiers need. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 10) The sentence that carries the whole social logic is hers too: going down is easy, because the gates only want to know where a person is headed; going back up requires somebody important to claim you deserve to return.

THE NINE TIERS

#	TIER	SURFACE OR UNDERGROUND	FUNCTION PER WORLDBUILDING (◩ SUPPORTED)	ON-PAGE IN 3SL (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)
1	Crownlight	Surface-level ● CANON	High Confessor's seat; Synod lawmaking; controlled climate; access controlled by the High Council of the Order of Silence	Nearest the surface; where the Synod makes laws (ch. 10). Crownlight prayer on the Sixth Ward search writ (ch. 12); fresh coins read as "fresh Crownlight issue" (ch. 9)
2	Dawnveil	Surface-level ● CANON	Wealth and culture; arts; normalized "calming" Dimming	Jerrick's forged Dawnveil route token (chs. 1, 9); a real one can move a person past two guarded tiers (ch. 1)
3	Ironcross	Fully subterranean by this tier ● CANON	Trade, markets, contracts, circulation records	Danika lives here; Ironcross owns Halflight's locks and records every declared weapon (chs. 2, 10); Micah's sponsorship would move him here (ch. 2)
4	Stoneveil	Underground ● CANON	Military; training; stability	Jude tracks holding wards between Shadowmere and Stoneveil (ch. 1)
5	Lowtorch	Underground ● CANON	Forges and industry	Jerrick is a Lowtorch man with furnace burn scars (ch. 1); freight lifts groan toward it from Ashvein (ch. 2)
6	Ashvein	Underground ● CANON	Mining; magical storms; community vigilance	Work bells instead of a sky; coal smoke; red-brown dust; blue-white flashes and grounding wires; coded lanterns; the Wraithmoor row in Sixth Ward (chs. 2, 6, 12)
7	Shadowmere	Underground ● CANON	Cold, damp; aurora; black market; pits	Violet mist; rain from the cavern ceiling; neon; the Back Market; Gutterlight's Pit (chs. 1, 3, 4)
8	Gravebend	Underground ● CANON	Funerary rites; catacombs; Wardens	Below Shadowmere; the violet rift-light leaks up from somewhere beneath it (ch. 5)

#	TIER	SURFACE OR UNDERGROUND	FUNCTION PER WORLDBUILDING (SUPPORTED)	ON-PAGE IN 3SL (CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)
9	Nightroot	Underground ● CANON	Mycelial network; deepest tier	Named on Halflight's board (ch. 10)

How the tiers connect, as drafted. Ashvein and Shadowmere are joined by a chasm bridge over a violet mist vent, patrolled at the Shadowmere end (ch. 4); the worldbuilding describes the same crossing. Freight lifts, tier gates, public trams, and a private burial rail carry the rest (chs. 1, 6, 8, 20). Halflight, an old transfer station half a staircase beneath Ashvein and one locked door above Shadowmere, sits between the two tiers under Ironcross ownership (ch. 10). Every tier move needs "active authorization under the Doctrine of Descent" (ch. 1).

GUARDRAIL

Sky and surface are relative to the tier you're in. When Silas tells Melena the sky is "six tiers above you" in Shadowmere (ch. 5), that's consistent with Crownlight sitting near the surface. It doesn't tell you where the surface transition falls between Dawnveil and Ironcross, or how deep anything is.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE CROSS-SECTION · ○ OPEN

FIXED
Crownlight and Dawnveil surface-level; fully underground by Ironcross; the attachment off Zenithia's side (TCD-025, TCD-026). Not ruled: the nine-tier count and order are ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (ch. 10).

UNDECIDED
Each tier's depth or elevation; where exactly the descent goes underground; tier boundaries; how lifts, rails, and routes run between specific tiers beyond what's drafted.

WHY IT MATTERS
Travel time between tiers sets how fast news, Shrouds, and Synod seals can move, which the draft already uses as a clock.

DECIDE BY
Safe to defer until a scene needs a travel time between non-adjacent tiers.

WORKING SPACE · THE CROSS-SECTION

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-025, TCD-026; 3SL draft chs. 1–5, 10, 12;* 3SL Full Worldbuilding *(tier functions, connections). Record: Vertical Underside Cross-Section.*

SEE ALSO II.2 Macro Geography · **p.27**

III.6 Routes in the Underside and the Remnian Crossing · **p.60**

RECORD · VERTICAL UNDERSIDE CROSS-SECTION (RELATIVE ORDER ONLY)

1 Crownlight

2 Dawnveil

SURFACE TRANSITION · somewhere between Dawnveil and Ironcross — ○ OPEN

3 Ironcross

4 Stoneveil

5 Lowtorch

6 Ashvein

7 Shadowmere

8 Gravebend

9 Nightroot

● **CANON** Crownlight and Dawnveil surface/above-ground; fully underground by Ironcross; attached off Zenithia's side. TCD-025 · TCD-026

■ **DRAFTED** Nine tiers in this order. 3SL ch. 10

○ **OPEN** Depths, elevations, tier boundaries, and where the descent goes underground. Not to scale; no depths are implied.

NOTES · III.3

III.4 SHADOWMERE AND 3 SHADOWMERE LANE

Ground the book's home tier and safehouse.

Shadowmere is Tier 7, and it's where the book lives. As drafted, it's cold and wet: rain collects along the cavern ceiling and falls hardest near Gutterlight where the heat keeps the stone sweating, violet mist covers the lower streets, and neon burns through it in broken patches. Coded lanterns tell anyone who can read them what the street is doing: amber for an open route, blue for somebody watching, red for keep moving. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 1) Isola, arriving from Ashvein, reads the difference in one line: Ashvein's gangs wear their colors, but Shadowmere smiles, sells you something, and lets you find out who owns the street when your payment comes up short (ch. 4).

SHADOWMERE PLACES ON THE PAGE

PLACE	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	CHAPTERS
Gutterlight Ring ("the Pit")	Silas's fights; Bookkeepers, the Floor Judge, Cage Wardens, and Quiet Staff; official rules prohibit killing, and the paperwork says otherwise	1, 5
The Back Market	Weapons, ward thread, bottled memories, Hush, funeral goods; Pell's salt stall, where Silas and Isola first collide	1, 3, 4
The Mercer building	Dante's office and map room; three route marks by the door (Access, Passage, Return); no sign carries the family name	3, 9
Mercer safehouse near Gutterlight	Behind a false utility panel beside a closed tailor shop; no windows; the Ring roars behind its eastern wall	3, 5, 7
Blue Circle	A Hush den under an old bathhouse three streets from Gutterlight; Miss Ora's; burned in ch. 7	7–9
Letter Row and Blue Six	The old archive's dead boxes; Blue Six is the counterfeit drop	9, 11, 13
South Bridge and the wash crypt	Where Silas brings Isola up out of the funeral road	16–17

PLACE	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	CHAPTERS

Number 3 Shadowmere Lane. In chapter 1, the book's title address is Silas's building: a blackened-brick building between a tailor shop and a threshold worker, reached from the Third Lane tram stop about twenty minutes from Gutterlight, with Silas's apartment, 3C, up a flight of stairs. Camille has half-moved into it. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 1)

◇ CONFLICT (INTERNAL DRAFTING FLAG)

Which building is the safehouse?

Chapter 3 places Melena's safehouse behind a false panel beside the Gutterlight Ring, with no windows. Chapter 11 calls the burning safehouse "3 Shadowmere Lane" and gives it a second-floor window. Chapter 1 puts 3 Shadowmere Lane a twenty-minute tram ride from Gutterlight. Chapter 17 has the safehouse across a lane from South Bridge. These may be one building, two buildings, or a revision in progress. The Companion doesn't choose. Settle it when the safehouse next appears on-page.

Why it matters: the title is an address, and the draft has already used it for two different kinds of place, a home and a hiding place. Whichever way it lands, it'll carry meaning.

SOURCE *3SL draft chs. 1, 3–5, 7–11, 13, 16–17.*

SEE ALSO III.5 Underside Institutions, Factions, and Pressures · p.56

III.9 Silas Graves · p.73 III.14 Melena and Remy in Shadowmere · p.90

NOTES · III.4

FACTION TABLE · PART III · 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

III.5 UNDERSIDE INSTITUTIONS, FACTIONS, AND PRESSURES

Map who holds power over movement, law, and violence.

The Synod governs by controlling movement, names, and memory, and almost every drafted scene is shaped by who else has learned to work around it. As drafted, the Synod's authority reaches every tier through the Doctrine of Descent (announced on the trams), its enforcement arms (Shrouds and Quietcasters), and its paperwork (route inspections, household audits, work chits). Its currency carries its creed: every legal Veilmark bears the Veiled One's face and the prayer *The Veil protects*. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 1, 2, 9, 12)

The worldbuilding adds a fuller government above what the draft shows: a theocratic hierarchy under the Order of Silence, with the High Confessor in Crownlight as spiritual and political head, the Synod as a council of nine elders who approve major decisions and death sentences, Viceroys over each tier, and Enforcers of Silence as theocratic police. ◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL. The draft names the Synod constantly and hasn't yet put the High Confessor, the Viceroys, or the Order of Silence on the page.

WHO HOLDS POWER OVER MOVEMENT, LAW, AND VIOLENCE

POWER	ROLE ON-PAGE	LEVERAGE	WHAT IT KNOWS OR CONTROLS	STATUS
The Synod	Law, doctrine, currency, route authorization, audits, executions	Can seal a ward, strip a registry, void a sponsorship, execute counterfeiters by Silencecraft	Searches the hands carrying counterfeit, not the box filling them (ch. 13)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Shrouds	Synod death-magic enforcers; veiled, bone-marked, carrying name strips and Silence seals	Death tethers; Silence that steals sound and witnesses	One Shroud's forehead carries a Graves mark (ch. 15)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

POWER	ROLE ON-PAGE	LEVERAGE	WHAT IT KNOWS OR CONTROLS	STATUS
Quietcasters	Silencecraft operatives	Public execution of counterfeiters; walk the edges of suspect territory	Were watching Mother Rae's routes (ch. 3)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Ironcross	Neutral contracts and records	Owns Halflight's locks; records every declared weapon and blacks out violators' contracts and crossings	Registers who enters and exits by which tier	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
The Mercers (Dante)	Brokers of routes, access, and movement	Tokens, passages, map-room route board; can suspend a son's access	"People who needed the Mercers already knew the address"	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
The Graves (Camille)	Thresholds, funeral work, contracts, death-architecture	Wards, grave nails, funeral thread, name hooks	Built half the thresholds on Gutterlight's streets	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; magic per *Character Outlines* (◪ SUPPORTED)
Mother Rae (Maven Renae Vellum)	Godmother, route-holder, fixer across tiers	Passage tokens, old route phrases, godbinding authority	Knew Lucia; her routes are watched after an old passage name was used	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Gutterlight Pit	Bookkeepers, Floor Judge, Cage Wardens, Quiet Staff	Fights, bets, and records that "make damn near anything true"	Official report says Jerrick died after the match	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Blue Circle	Hush den under an old bathhouse; runners with blue cords	Holds counterfeit handoffs; charges losses back to couriers	Six deliveries through Asha; Blue Six on Letter Row	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

POWER	ROLE ON-PAGE	LEVERAGE	WHAT IT KNOWS OR CONTROLS	STATUS
Ashvein crews and aunties	Block-level order	Colors, toll gates, social pressure	Watch the Wraithmoors over Danika's money	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; history per *Character Outlines*

Godbinding outranks blood in Shadowmere. The children you make are yours because blood says so; a godchild belongs to you because you stood before witnesses, spoke their name, and chose responsibility for a life you didn't create. Dante is godfather to Micah and Asha, and if either one calls, the Mercer-Graves children know everybody moves. Mother Rae is Isola's godmother; "Renae" is Isola's godbinding name. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 9; ch. 12 registry)

Name chains are survival infrastructure. Ashvein families carry several names each so the Synod can't erase a person by striking one record. Isola is Isola Amara Renae Wraithmoor: given name, mother-line name, godbinding name, and block name. The Wraithmoor hallway holds four generations of handwritten name chains so the family can put back any name the Synod removes. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 2, 12; the naming logic is explained in *Character Outlines*, ◩ SUPPORTED)

NOT THE SAME AS

Blue Circle is the den. Blue Six is the dead box on Letter Row. The Synod searched and sealed the first and ignored the second (ch. 13).

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · MAPPING THE SYNOD · ○ OPEN

FIXED
The Synod's drafted powers and arms above.

UNDECIDED
How the worldbuilding's High Confessor, Order of Silence, Viceroys, and Enforcers map onto the drafted Synod; whether the draft's "Synod" means the council of nine or the whole apparatus; who inside it knows about Blue Six.

WHY IT MATTERS
The counterfeit coins are built to climb, and whoever fills Blue Six has access to legal quicksilver. The answer points up-tier.

DECIDE BY
Before the counterfeit plot names who's behind Blue Six.

WORKING SPACE · MAPPING THE SYNOD

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *3SL draft chs. 1–3, 7–13, 15;* 3SL Full Worldbuilding *(Government & Political Structure; Religious Authority Structure);* 3SL Character Outlines *(Camille; name chains).*

SEE ALSO III.6 Routes in the Underside and the Remnian Crossing · **p.60**

III.13 Supporting Cast · **p.86**

III.6 ROUTES IN THE UNDERSIDE AND THE REMNIAN CROSSING

Apply route logic locally.

Routes are the Underside's real economy. Every drafted plotline turns on who's allowed to move, who pays to move, and who opens a door nobody else can see. The route logic from II.3 applies: routes are physical-magical passages, not portals, and each one's reach is its own fact.

● CANON TCD-017

DRAFTED ROUTES BY CLASS

ROUTE	CLASS	CONTROLLER	ACCESS	WHO KNOWS IT	STATUS
Ashvein–Shadowmere chasm bridge	Tier	Patrolled at the Shadowmere end by a mercenary with a route scanner	Token, blood, payment, or family pledge; Mother Rae's token skips all three	Public	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT , ch. 4
Tier gates, lifts, public trams	Tier	Synod, under the Doctrine of Descent	Route permissions; work chits	Public	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT , chs. 1, 8
Mercer passages and safehouse routes	Restricted / Institutional	Dante Mercer	Brass route tokens; Mercer blood; Mercer marks in a coat	Mercer family and trusted staff	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT , chs. 3, 5, 9
Mother Rae's routes	Restricted / Institutional	Mother Rae	Passage tokens; old route phrases	Rae; her goddaughter carries one	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT , chs. 3–4, 8

ROUTE	CLASS	CONTROLLER	ACCESS	WHO KNOWS IT	STATUS
Halflight	Neutral Transit	Ironcross	Registered entry tier and exit tier; declared weapons	Public, by appointment	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT , ch. 10
Blue Circle drop and Blue Six	Underground / Smuggling	Unknown, above Blue Circle	Sealed packages; route strips	Asha, Blue Circle runners, Silas, Jude	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT , chs. 6, 9
Private burial rail	Restricted / Institutional	Unstated; used by the Mercer-Graves for moving the living as the dead	Funeral trolleys; service platforms	Silas; Graves work	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT , ch. 20
The funeral road (dead routes)	○ OPEN — not yet classifiable	Graveshand opens it; Graves thresholds close it	Silas's blood and Graves marks	Silas, and the dead	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT , chs. 15–16
Loading cut → NEUTRAL TRANSIT station	○ OPEN — carries a Neutral Transit plate	Unknown	Remy's blood on a plate; an access phrase	Remy	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT , ch. 22

The station behind the loading cut. It's the most consequential route in the draft, and nearly everything about it is unanswered. What's on the page: a bronze plate reading NEUTRAL TRANSIT in worn trade lettering, with five seals beneath it and one cut away; signs in several scripts, including common route marks and symbols Silas doesn't know; a line of blue enamel numbers Melena identifies as Remnian; a green mark of two hooked lines crossed inside a narrow oval, which Remy clearly recognizes; floor lamps that wake along a corridor; a gate that lifts to show more track. A mark of a broken circle crossed by four short bars appears on the wall under Remy's hand and on Remy's own wrist. Every Underside passage Silas knows declares an owner, a tier, and an authority. This one declares none. Silas, Isola, and Rhea can't follow Remy and Melena through. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 22)

GUARDRAIL

Don't assume the NEUTRAL TRANSIT station is the Remnia–Underside crossing in TCD-027. Melena reading the numbers as Remnian is her identification, not a ruling, and TCD-017 says no route has every capability. It may be the crossing, part of it, or something else.

Melena's way in. Dante says she crossed seven tiers without burning through one; Mother Rae opened the final routes; Melena wore a veil until Shadowmere; the route phrase in Lucia's letter should've been dead twenty years. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 3) As drafted, that reads as a descent through the tiers rather than a direct arrival in Shadowmere, but it doesn't say which crossing brought her out of Remnia.

WHO KNOWS ROUTES, AS OF CH. 22

CHARACTER	ROUTE KNOWLEDGE
Silas	Mercer routes, Graves thresholds, the burial rail, the loading cut (used twice for Graves work, always a dead end). Didn't know the station existed.
Isola	Ashvein lanes and trench routes; Mother Rae's passage token, though she hasn't been taught to read its route phrase (ch. 4); black three
Melena	Almost none in the Underside. Recognizes Remnian route numbers and says Remnia doesn't have the other symbols.
Remy	The hidden station, its blood key, its access phrase, and the green mark. How he knows is ○ OPEN.
Rhea	Graves routes and the funeral road; directs Silas through it by blood-route

III.6 · ROUTES IN THE UNDERSIDE AND THE REMNIAN CROSSING

CONTINUED

CHARACTER	ROUTE KNOWLEDGE

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE TRANSIT ROUTE AT THE STOP POINT · ○ OPEN

FIXED
The station exists as drafted; Remy and Melena went through; Silas, Isola, and Rhea couldn't.

UNDECIDED
Where it goes; who built and sealed it; why one of five seals is cut; why the others can't pass; how Remy knows it; what his access phrase and wrist mark mean; whether it relates to the TCD-027 crossing (whose coordinate and arrival tier are also open).

WHY IT MATTERS
Remy's death is fixed and Tiran's cleanup follows it. Wherever this corridor goes is the road to that climax.

DECIDE BY
Before drafting ch. 23.

WORKING SPACE · THE TRANSIT ROUTE AT THE STOP POINT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-017, TCD-027; 3SL draft chs. 1, 3–6, 8–10, 15–16, 20, 22. Record: Route Classification System (Underside layer).*

III.6 · ROUTES IN THE UNDERSIDE AND THE REMNIAN CROSSING

CONTINUED

SEE ALSO II.3 Routes and Cross-Land Transit · **p.29**

VII.4 Route and Transit Timeline → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

NOTES · III.6

REFERENCE TABLE · PART III · 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

III.7 THE SIX DISCIPLINES

Teach the formal Underside magic system as institutions classify it.

The Underside's formal magic is organized into six Disciplines, and the worldbuilding's framing is blunt: every discipline is part of a control war. ◩ SUPPORTED / PROVISIONAL, *3SL Full Worldbuilding*. Their shared substance is life, death, grief, and memory. Silas puts the same idea in drafted terms when Melena's fire appears: the Underside produces thanomancers, Root-Listeners, lament workers, and people who can pull memories from the dark, and their magic comes from everything between life and death (ch. 3). That's his belief about his own nation's magic, and it matches the file.

DISCIPLINE	WHAT IT DOES, PER WORLDBUILDING	WHY POWER FEARS OR USES IT	ON THE PAGE
Thanomancy	Death-speaking and death-witnessing: hearing and interacting with the dead, dying, and those who refuse to be either	The dead can testify	"Thanomancers" named (ch. 3)
Lamentcraft	Turning grief into fuel and thread	Grief can power more than obedience	"Lament workers" named (ch. 3); grief thread in Blue Circle's walls (ch. 7)
Silencecraft	Erasing witnesses: the Muting, the Dimming (sold in Shadowmere as Hush), the Blanking, the Unnaming, the Severing, the Quiet Burial	The Synod's instrument against the other five	Silence seals, Quietcasters, Shroud patrols, Hush, execution of counterfeiters (chs. 2, 5, 7, 12)
Underchant Cant	Speaking around cages: words as thresholds, agreements as wards, names as leverage	People will always find a way to speak around control	Rhea's chants over Isola; route-paper markings; Camille's primary art (chs. 6, 17; *Character Outlines*)
Funereal Engineering	The death-architecture that keeps the dead from becoming a second population	The backbone of the system	Camille's thresholds, grave nails, funeral boards, funeral thread (chs. 1, 17–18)
Mycelial Memory	Living storage in Nightroot that keeps emotional truth even when records are edited	The part the Synod can't fully own	"Root-Listeners" named (ch. 3)

All six belong to the Underside's modern branch of the shared primordial substrate. They're genuinely distinct from Remnian, Somnorian, and Thalaran magic, whatever resemblances turn up. ● CANON TCD-035

NOT THE SAME AS

Silencecraft's Severing (cutting tether-lines, family recognition, oath bindings) is a Synod discipline in the worldbuilding. Silas's Severance is Graveshand. The names rhyme; the magics aren't established as the same.

TERMINOLOGY NOTE

The worldbuilding says "Lamentcraft" and "Rootwhisper/Rootwhisperers"; the *Character Outlines* give Camille "Lamentchant"; the draft says "lament workers" and "Root-Listeners." None of these is ruled. Treat the worldbuilding names as the working taxonomy and the others as in-world or character usage until Danyelle picks.

SOURCE *TCD-035;* 3SL Full Worldbuilding *(Six Disciplines; Silencecraft functions);* 3SL Character Outlines *(Camille); 3SL draft chs. 2–3, 5–7, 12, 17–18.*

SEE ALSO II.5 Shared Magical Ancestry · **p.34**

III.8 Graveshand, Deathwork, and Severance · **p.67**

NOTES · III.7

EXPLAINER · PART III · 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

III.8 GRAVESHAND, DEATHWORK, AND SEVERANCE

The book's magical core, taught precisely.

Graveshand is inherited Graves-family magic, and it sits outside the formal Six Disciplines. ● CANON TCD-004. Deathwork is the broader category: ending-magic and its effects, which Graveshand can perceive, manipulate, sever, redirect, or create. A Shroud's death tether is Deathwork. Silas's answer to it is Graveshand.

NOT THE SAME AS

Graveshand / Deathwork.

Deathwork is what endings do. Graveshand is what the Graves line can do to endings. A Shroud uses Deathwork without Graveshand; Silas uses Graveshand on Deathwork. (TCD-004)

What Graveshand is, as the draft shows it. Silas's tattoos aren't decoration. They're Graves marks, death names Camille bound into him: "one for the family, one for the route, one for everything that came through and needed putting back" (ch. 15). Opening Graveshand doesn't just let him touch death. It gives death a route back to him. Once he opens it, every dead thing nearby knows exactly where he stands, and so does anything else listening (ch. 15). Camille taught all three of her children the family rule before she taught them the working: *never call the dead unless you're prepared to answer what comes*. Severance calls louder than anything. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 15)

THE HALFLIGHT SEVERANCE, BEAT BY BEAT (CH. 15)

1. A Shroud lays a death tether in Isola's leg: three black branches above the ankle, one climbing behind the knee, one sinking toward bone. Silas knows three ways to stop it: cut the limb before the black reaches her hip; kill the Shroud and hope its work dies with it; or use Graveshand, knowing what happens when two death marks meet inside a living body.
2. He splits the half-healed burn Melena left on his palm and drags his blood down the Synod gate: "Welcome me home."
3. Halflight disappears. He stands in the dead routes under the station, old transfer paths, execution roads, buried funeral passages, and the dead who died trying to climb Halflight reach for him.
4. He wraps the Shroud's tether around his bleeding hand. The Shroud's face is made of name strips, and the strip across its forehead carries a Graves mark cut with Dante's hook.
5. "Mine. She came through my gate. Her severance is mine." The dead stop; so does the Shroud.
6. He drives his palm into the mark on its forehead. The Shroud comes apart into name strips. Every name inside it starts talking.
7. The tether snaps. His blood spreads through the gate bars and opens every lock. He crosses into Ashvein under white Synod prayer reading *Unauthorized transfer* and *High Heresy*.

The five laws. Danyelle approved these on 2026-08-22 as the working continuity baseline for Graveshand and Severance. ● CANON Explicit prior author ruling, 2026-08-22 (no TCD number assigned). Every Severance on the page has to obey all five.

LAW	WHERE THE DRAFT ALREADY SHOWS IT (COMPANION READING)	DRAFTING IMPLICATION
1. Graveshand/Deathwork requires a connection.	Silas can't act on the Shroud's tether until he takes hold of it and wraps it around his bleeding hand; his blood goes into the gate first (ch. 15). The claim runs through his hand on Isola's shoulder (chs. 17–18).	No working at a distance without a line to hold. Put the connection on the page before the Severance.

LAW	WHERE THE DRAFT ALREADY SHOWS IT (COMPANION READING)	DRAFTING IMPLICATION
2. Silas must understand what he is severing or ending.	He reads the tether before he acts (three branches above the ankle, one behind the knee, one toward bone) and knows what happens when two death marks meet in a living body (ch. 15). He knows exactly whom he's binding: "I know who" (chs. 17–18).	He can't end what he can't read. An unfamiliar working should stop him, slow him, or cost more.
3. Every ending leaves remains.	"He'd removed the claim, not the damage." Isola's leg stays hollowed (chs. 15, 17). The Shroud leaves name strips and hundreds of talking names (ch. 15).	There are no clean endings. Draft what's left behind every time.
4. Remains can follow the connection home.	The dead follow him through his marks, hook beneath his spine, and settle on his chain; Rhea's funeral terms travel back up Graveshand into him (chs. 15–18, 22).	Whatever he ends may come back up the line to him. Track where the remains go after each working.
5. Silas's body imitates the ending.	His hand turns black and cold like the deathwork he held (ch. 16); a drowned man fills his lungs with black water, and later he pulls air "through the drowned man's lungs" (chs. 18, 22); after binding a dying woman to himself, he stops breathing (chs. 18, 21).	His injuries echo the specific endings he touches. They're never generic magical damage.

The middle column is the Companion's reading of drafted scenes against the ruled laws. The laws themselves are canon; the mapping is a drafting aid.

Beyond the five laws, the draft establishes these further behaviors:

WHAT THE DRAFT ESTABLISHES ABOUT HOW IT WORKS

DRAFTED BEHAVIOR	WHERE	DRAFTING IMPLICATION
Graveshand works through contact and blood	ch. 15	Silas has to touch the tether and bleed into the work
Removing a claim doesn't remove the damage	ch. 15 ("He'd removed the claim, not the damage.")	Isola's leg stays hollowed after the Severance; no later scene can erase that without a new cause

DRAFTED BEHAVIOR	WHERE	DRAFTING IMPLICATION
The dead follow an opened Graveshand home	chs. 15–18	Dead hands hook beneath his marks, ride his chain, and press on thresholds wherever he goes
Funeral terms spoken over Graveshand work travel back to him	ch. 17	Rhea's closing terms settle into Silas's arm instead of Isola's leg
Graves marks can't simply be lifted	ch. 18	Camille's hook under the first letter of Isola's name sends Isola's deathwork climbing again; she withdraws
"Mine" is Graves law	chs. 17–18	It means protection until burial, no other hand collects the body, and responsibility: if Isola dies under his hand, every dead route inside him keeps her

Costs on the page. Silas's right hand turns black to the second knuckle, goes numb, and bleeds cold (ch. 16). Black lines push under his collar. He collapses, loses breath and pulse more than once, and needs Camille's boards and grave nails, Rhea's chants, and Selah's working to stay alive (chs. 18–21). The dead don't leave; Rhea finally ties a grave nail to his chain so they settle there instead of in the board (ch. 22). Opening Graveshand also opens the childhood blood-route between Silas, Jude, and Rhea, and Dante notices. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)

Institutional versus personal knowledge. Rhea and Camille know Graves methods and use them; Camille can't close what Silas opened (ch. 18). Rhea's warning is the working rule going forward: open Graveshand again and she'll put him in a coffin until Camille figures out how to close it (ch. 22). What the Synod knows about Graveshand isn't shown, beyond Halflight's alarm hitting "the Graves board" because Ironcross used an old funeral lock (ch. 16). (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT; Synod knowledge ○ OPEN)

Writing application: map a new Severance before you draft it. Check it against the five laws first, then against the drafted behavior.

QUESTION	LAW	YOUR ANSWER FOR THE NEXT SEVERANCE
What connection is he holding, and how did he get it?	1	
What is he ending, and does he understand it well enough to end it?	2	
What remains stay behind after the claim is gone?	3	
Which remains follow the connection home, and where do they settle?	4	
How does his body imitate this particular ending?	5	
Who hears it: Jude, Rhea, Dante, the Synod?	Drafted behavior	

III.8 · GRAVESHAND, DEATHWORK, AND SEVERANCE — CONTINUED

SOURCE *TCD-004; 3SL draft chs. 15–22; five laws by explicit author ruling, 2026-08-22.*

SEE ALSO III.9 Silas Graves · **p.73** | III.11 The Tether (involuntary track) · **p.79**

NOTES · III.8

DOSSIER · PROTAGONIST · PART III · 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

III.9 SILAS GRAVES

Full protagonist dossier.

Silas is the son who does the family's quiet work and the fighting his father won't approve of, and by chapter 22 he has done the one thing his family taught him never to do in front of witnesses. On-page he's a Mercer-Graves: Dante Mercer's son, Camille Graves's son, brother to Rhea and Jude, Remy's closest friend. He goes by Graves. The book opens on his twenty-fourth kill in the Gutterlight Pit, and the first chapter's arithmetic (threw up the first time, drank water without tasting blood by the nineteenth, didn't blink by the twenty-third) is the whole man in five lines. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 1)

LANES

LANE	WHAT THE SOURCES ESTABLISH	STATUS
Wants	His people alive. He keeps Remy, Jude, and the runners Jerrick sold in his accounting; he breaks Dante's orders the moment Isola calls.	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 1, 15
Fears	Helplessness. "Helplessness wasn't an option" is how he refuses the dead in ch. 18. The *Character Outline*s trace it to a loss in his late teens: Remy's sister's death in a pit-adjacent accident.	Drafted line; origin ◩ SUPPORTED
Beliefs	Rules exist for whoever paid for them ("Folks heard rules and forgot to ask who paid for them," ch. 1). Choosing how to do what he's already decided is still choosing, which Camille tells him isn't the same as volition (ch. 1).	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Obligations	Dante's assignment to keep Melena alive and hidden; Dante's rules for Isola (stay on the Shadowmere side, don't use her to reach Asha, keep his hands off her). He keeps the first imperfectly and breaks the second at Halflight.	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 3, 9, 13, 15
Relationship to Graveshand	Knows the working and the family rule; opens it for Isola knowing what it will call	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 15
Body at the stop point	Right hand black and useless; left leg failing; dead settled on his chain; breath and pulse tied to Isola's; moves only in contact with her	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 22

WHAT SILAS KNOWS, AND SINCE WHEN

KNOWLEDGE	FROM	CHAPTER
Melena is Remnia's Imperial Princess and Lucia's daughter	Dante	3
Lucia came through Dante's office more than once and got people out; he met her when he was seventeen	His own memory	11
Somnoria exists (by name)	Unstated; Remy jokes about it	11
The counterfeit shares its binding compound with Jerrick's Dawnveil token	Jude's testing	9
Asha carried the counterfeit through Blue Circle	Dante's naming and his own deduction	11, 13
Isola's full name	It enters the working without him speaking it	17–18
The Shroud's forehead mark was cut with Dante's hook	What he sees in the dead routes	15
The loading-cut station exists	Remy opens it	22

GUARDRAIL

Silas's pit reputation and his Graves work are different things. The *Character Outline*s build his name, "Graves," from what happened after his fights rather than the fights themselves. The draft shows him killing openly in the Ring. Don't let either version erase the other.

III.9 · SILAS GRAVES

CONTINUED

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · SILAS AFTER CHAPTER 22 · ○ OPEN

FIXED
He's alive at the end of 3SL and ends it on a different immediate path from Isola (TCD-044). Whether he's the next Shadowmere installment's focus isn't ruled; TCD-054 refers only to "the next Shadowmere character."

UNDECIDED
Whether he can close Graveshand; what the black hand becomes; what he learns about Dante's mark; what Remy's death changes in him.

WHY IT MATTERS
His arc has to carry the romance and the tether through the climax without either one resolving the other.

DECIDE BY
Before the climax sequence.

WORKING SPACE · SILAS AFTER CHAPTER 22

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *3SL draft chs. 1, 3, 9, 11, 13, 15–22;* 3SL Character Outlines *(Silas; Remy's sister). Ages in the* Character Outlines *aren't used here; the audit notes its top-sheet ages describe a later time jump.*

SEE ALSO

III.8 Graveshand, Deathwork, and Severance · p.67

III.11 The Tether (involuntary track) · p.79

III.12 Silas and Isola (voluntary track) · p.82

III.18 Handoff into FTE and the Next Shadowmere Book · p.102

DOSSIER · PROTAGONIST · PART III · 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

III.10 ISOLA WRAITHMOOR

Full protagonist dossier.

Isola is the one her family calls when something has to be handled, and that's exactly why the book breaks her leg and binds her to a stranger without asking. She's Isola Amara Renae Wraithmoor of Ashvein's Sixth Ward: daughter of Selah and Omari, sister to Danika in Ironcross and eighteen-year-old Micah, raised alongside her cousins Tevin and Asha, goddaughter of Mother Rae, and the family member Mother Rae sends across tiers with passage tokens. She wears Ironcross rings heavy enough to break skin and a knife on her right thigh, and she can read a lie in three sentences. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 2, 4, 10, 12)

What she does on the page. She gets Micah's thirty-day Ironcross packet together. She finds Asha's counterfeit and hides it. She makes Pell sell Mother Rae real funeral salt. She follows Asha to Blue Circle, confronts her, and takes the coin to Mother Rae. She meets Silas at Halflight and takes his tag on her own terms. When the Synod raids the house, she hides the coin in the ash chute and chooses not to call Silas, because Asha threatens to run if she does. When a Shroud lays a death tether in her leg, she takes a blackened name strip from it ("I got what it wants"), sends Asha toward Mother Rae, runs for Halflight, and calls. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14)

Her body after Halflight. The claim is gone and the damage isn't. Dead channels won't carry living blood; muscle and bone are torn through. Selah gets blood back into her foot but can't make the routes the Shroud killed come back, and when Isola asks if she can walk, her mother says no. She leaves the house in a brace with a shortened crutch, putting as little weight on the leg as she can. ● CANON TCD-057; ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 17, 20–22

THE TETHER: WHAT IT IS VERSUS WHAT SHE KNOWS

LANE	CONTENT	STATUS
Objective	Silas bound her name into his wrist under Graves law to keep her alive; she didn't consent; the tether isn't romance or evidence of consent	● CANON TCD-044; ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 17–18
What she can feel	His pulse half a count behind hers; his breath pulling on hers; the dead's attention crowded behind him; pain and stoppage when they separate; relief when they touch	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 19–22

LANE	CONTENT	STATUS
What she knows	Her name is on his wrist and she wants it off	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 21
What she believes about it	"That don't make what you did okay." She holds him responsible for the act.	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, ch. 21
What she doesn't know yet	What "Mine" means under Graves law; that Rhea and Remy told him not to; that the funeral terms followed Graveshand back to him	Not shown on-page as her knowledge
Who Melena is	She's seen Melena at Pell's stall and outside Blue Circle; in ch. 21 she asks, "Who the hell is Lucia?"	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 4, 8, 21

GUARDRAIL

Her agency after the violation belongs to her. The draft gives it to her immediately: she insists on going home, faces down Rhea, and demands the name off his wrist. Don't let the tether turn her into luggage.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · ISOLA'S LEG · ○ OPEN

FIXED
It stays ruined; the Elders' Prayer can't regenerate destroyed anatomy (TCD-057).

UNDECIDED
Long-term mobility; whether any Underside practice can partially restore function; how the leg interacts with the tether if the tether is ever cut.

WHY IT MATTERS
Her body is now part of every action scene she's in, and any later book that carries her inherits it.

DECIDE BY
Before any scene asks her to run.

WORKING SPACE · ISOLA'S LEG

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-044, TCD-057; 3SL draft chs. 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 17–22.*

SEE ALSO
III.11 The Tether (involuntary track) · p.79
III.12 Silas and Isola (voluntary track) · p.82
III.16 Selah and the Elders' Prayer in 3SL · p.97

THE TETHER (INVOLUNTARY TRACK)

III.11

Document the magic Silas created without Isola's consent, apart from romance.

Silas made the tether without Isola's consent, while she was dying and unconscious, and the draft doesn't pretend otherwise. It isn't romance and it isn't evidence of consent. ● CANON TCD-044. This page documents it as a piece of magic and an act, separate from anything the two of them choose.

How it was made (chs. 17–18). At the safehouse, Rhea's Underchant can't hold the deathwork in Isola's leg; the funeral terms slide off her and follow Graveshand back into Silas. The dead press on the western threshold, and a shape wearing Dante's shoulders strikes the door. Silas says "Mine" aloud, and every dead mouth in his marks repeats it. Rhea tells him he can't claim her. Remy says don't. Rhea asks him to take it back, and he refuses: "I know who." Isola Amara Renae Wraithmoor enters the working without him speaking it, and her first name opens letter by letter in wet-black ink between the older names on his left wrist. As the last letter closes, she takes a full breath and the deathwork pulls back from her hip. He collapses. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT)

WHAT IT DOES, AS DRAFTED

EFFECT	WHAT THE PAGE SHOWS	CHAPTER
Keeps her alive	Her breathing and pulse come back as the name closes; the highest branch stops climbing and turns toward his hand	17–18
Shared vital rhythm	His pulse runs through her half a count behind hers; his lungs pull on hers when he forgets a breath; her heart speeds when his slows	19–21
Separation hurts	When her grip slips as the trolleys are moved, she screams; when the tram jolts them apart, his lungs seize and her breath stops	19–20
Touch relieves	Skin contact quiets the dead, lets him breathe, and loosens the knot in her leg; the relief goes both ways	20
The dead come with it	She can feel the dead's attention crowded behind him through the tether	21

EFFECT	WHAT THE PAGE SHOWS	CHAPTER
It resists removal	Camille can't close the marks; lifting the first letter makes Isola's deathwork climb	18
It sets how they move	Selah: "Bring them together. That's how you move." They walk as one unit: her crutch, his good left arm, his useless right	22

GUARDRAIL

The tether is never evidence of consent. Relief at his touch isn't desire; pain at separation isn't longing; moving as one body isn't intimacy. When the draft gives these moments charge, the Companion records the charge in the voluntary track, not here. (TCD-044)

NOT THE SAME AS

The Shroud's death tether is Deathwork that was trying to take her. Silas's claim is Graves law and Graveshand keeping her. Both are tethers; only one is the "tether" this page means.

WHO KNOWS WHAT, AS OF CH. 22

PERSON	KNOWS
Silas	He did it, what "Mine" means under Graves law, and that Rhea and Remy told him not to
Isola	Her name is on his wrist; she can feel him and the dead; she wants it off and says what he did isn't okay
Rhea, Remy, Melena	Witnessed the claim
Camille	Tried to close it and failed
Selah	Worked through it; tells them to move together
Omari	Saw enough to beat Silas bloody; exactly what he knows about the claim isn't shown
Dante	Heard Jude answering a voice Dante couldn't hear; what he knows of the claim isn't shown

III.11 · THE TETHER (INVOLUNTARY TRACK)

CONTINUED

PERSON	KNOWS

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE TETHER IN BOOK ONE · ○ OPEN

FIXED
It exists, it was made without consent, and it stays mechanically separate from romance (TCD-044). Silas and Isola end the book on separate immediate paths (TCD-044), so whatever holds them together now has to loosen, change, or be survived by then.

UNDECIDED
Whether it's resolved, weakened, or carried forward; whether distance becomes survivable; what its cost to either of them is long term; whether the dead ever leave the chain.

WHY IT MATTERS
The ruled ending needs them apart. The drafted tether makes apart lethal. Something has to give, and it can't be her consent being assumed.

DECIDE BY
Before the climax sequence.

WORKING SPACE · THE TETHER IN BOOK ONE

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-044; 3SL draft chs. 15–22. Record: Silas/Isola Romance + Tether Progression (tether track).*

SEE ALSO III.8 Graveshand, Deathwork, and Severance · **p.67**

III.12 Silas and Isola (voluntary track) · **p.82**

III.12 SILAS AND ISOLA (VOLUNTARY TRACK)

Track chosen attraction, trust, and intimacy separately.

They chose each other a little before the book made the choice impossible to separate from survival, and the voluntary track exists to protect that earlier choosing. The ruled landing is clear: Silas and Isola become explicitly and mutually romantic during 3SL, crossing from subtext into substantial consensual physical choice before the novel ends, and they don't end as a settled, publicly defined couple. ● CANON TCD-044. The outline's restrained separation and future promise may survive only after that line has been crossed.

TWO-LANE PROGRESSION THROUGH CHAPTER 22

CH.	ROMANCE LANE (CHOSEN)	TETHER LANE (IMPOSED)	CONSENT / KNOWLEDGE STATE
4	They collide at Pell's stall. He reads her as a threat; her body doesn't know the difference. She spends the lift ride irritated by six seconds of him.	None	Mutual attraction; no names exchanged
6	She hasn't stopped thinking about the water in his beard. Mostly.	None	Private
9	Dante: keep your hands off her. "Which way you mean that?" "Both." Jude: he's definitely seen her.	None	Silas doesn't yet know her name
10	Halflight. Open flirtation across the Ironcross line; he keeps Dante's rule and doesn't touch her; she takes black three only after he moves his hand away. "What if I need something that ain't about the coin?" "Use the same route."	None	Mutual, verbal, chosen; he learns her name by deduction
11	He can't stop thinking about her; black three stays dark.	None	Private
12	She touches the tag three times before sleeping, then chooses not to call during the raid.	None	Her choice, under Asha's threat

CH.	ROMANCE LANE (CHOSEN)	TETHER LANE (IMPOSED)	CONSENT / KNOWLEDGE STATE
13	"Tell me you good."	None	His reach, unanswered
14	"OPEN HALFLIGHT."	None	Her choice to call him
15	He breaks his father's rules and crosses into Ashvein for her.	He claims her severance: "Her severance is mine."	She's being killed; no consent possible
17–18	None	He binds her name into his wrist over Rhea's and Remy's objections.	She's unconscious; no consent
20	On the tram she pushes his hand higher against her ribs and holds it there. Neither looks at the other again.	Touch relieves both of them.	Her physical choice under pain; the Companion records the act and doesn't read desire into it
21	Omari has beaten him (the beating falls between the tram and ch. 21; recalled here); Silas had Omari's arm and didn't break it, because he looked at her.	"I want this off me. That don't make what you did okay." "I ain't say it did."	She names the violation; he doesn't dispute it
22	They learn to walk together.	They can't walk apart.	Cooperation for survival, not a romantic beat

GUARDRAIL

Every romance beat after chapter 15 has to be readable with the tether switched off. If a moment only works because separation hurts, it belongs in the tether lane.

What the ruling still requires. An acknowledgment of the violation that goes further than "I ain't say it did." Choices restored to Isola in whatever form the story allows. Then the romantic line crossed on purpose, explicitly and consensually, before the ending. Then separate immediate paths.

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE ROMANTIC LANDING · ○ OPEN

FIXED	UNDECIDED
Explicit, mutual, consensual physical romance before the end; no settled public couple; separate immediate paths; the tether is not consent (TCD-044).	The first major romantic scene and where it falls; who initiates; how far it goes; how consent is repaired around the tether; what they call it afterward; the final wording between them.
WHY IT MATTERS	**DECIDE BY**
The ruling protects both halves of the book's promise. The reader gets the romance, and Isola gets to have chosen it.	Before drafting the first scene in which they're alone and conscious after ch. 22.

WORKING SPACE · THE ROMANTIC LANDING

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

III.12 · SILAS AND ISOLA (VOLUNTARY TRACK) CONTINUED

WRITING APPLICATION: TEST THE NEXT SILAS/ISOLA SCENE.

TEST	YOUR ANSWER
What does each of them choose in this scene that the tether doesn't force?	
Would the scene still read as romantic if they could stand apart?	
What does Isola know about the claim here that she didn't know in ch. 21?	
What has Silas said or done about the violation since "I ain't say it did"?	

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-044; 3SL draft chs. 4, 6, 9–15, 17–22. Record: Silas/Isola Romance + Tether Progression.*

SEE ALSO III.11 The Tether (involuntary track) · **p.79**

III.19 3SL Draft-Forward Packet · **p.104**

CAST TABLE · PART III · 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

SUPPORTING CAST

III.13

Role, allegiance, leverage, knowledge, status for each supporting figure.

The supporting cast is mostly two families and the people who owe them, and nearly everyone has a route, a debt, or a secret the plot will call in.

CHARACTER	ROLE ON-PAGE	ALLEGIANCE	LEVERAGE	WHAT THEY KNOW THAT MATTERS	STATUS AT CH. 22
Dante Mercer	Silas's father; route broker; godfather to Micah and Asha	Family; his godchildren first	Routes, tokens, access; can suspend a son's access	Melena's identity; Asha's role; the danger of the children's seals opening	Office in Shadowmere; the Graves mark on the Shroud was cut with his hook (unexplained)
Camille Inez Graves	Silas's mother; threshold and funeral work	Family	Wards, grave nails, funeral thread	Graves methods; she couldn't close Silas's work	Left the safehouse after binding Silas to a funeral board
Rhea Mercer-Graves	Silas's sister; Graves working and Underchant	Family	Blood-route; funeral terms; directs Silas through dead routes	Hasn't spoken to Dante in over a year; was working a contract that touches the Synod (ch. 3)	Hiding in the brake recess with Silas and Isola
Jude Mercer	Silas's brother; testing, tokens, Blue Six watch	Family	Traces the counterfeit compound; blood-route	Dante saw him listening to Silas; he cut the route	In Dante's office, under Dante's eye
Remy (Remington Alaric Moreno)	Silas's closest friend; Melena's anchor	Silas; Melena	Ora owes him; a hidden route only he can open	The NEUTRAL TRANSIT station and its access phrase	Alive; through the corridor with Melena

CHARACTER	ROLE ON-PAGE	ALLEGIANCE	LEVERAGE	WHAT THEY KNOW THAT MATTERS	STATUS AT CH. 22
Mother Rae (Maven Renae Vellum)	Isola's godmother; route-holder	Her godchildren; her block	Passage tokens; old route phrases; Dante's ear	Knew Lucia; arranged Melena's arrival and the Halflight meeting	Asha was sent to her by the funeral-cloth route
Selah Maris Wraithmoor	Isola's mother	Family	Cold working; household rule	Knew Lucia by sight; performed the Prayer	Hands numb and frost-bitten past the elbows
Omari Kade Wraithmoor	Isola's father	Family	House panels, locks, keys, maps	The coin was under his stove	Stays with the house
Micah Amari Wraithmoor	Isola's brother, 18; Dante's godson	Family	His Ironcross sponsorship (stamped under audit)	Nearly followed Tevin into a fight	Watching the house
Tevin Malachi Wraithmoor	Cousin; loud loyalty	Family	Fists	Checks routes for the family	Watching the house
Asha Noelle Wraithmoor	Cousin; Blue Circle courier; Dante's goddaughter	Herself, then family	The route strip; the counterfeit	Six deliveries; name clearance promised at 180 Veils; ordered to report at third bell	With the family at the end; hugs Isola goodbye
Danika Wraithmoor	Isola's sister in Ironcross	Family	Sponsorship; Ironcross records	Put a private watch on Micah's record	Ironcross
Miss Ora	Blue Circle's keeper	Her den	Hush; route ledger	Her clerk sold Melena full Hush	Den burned and route-scrambled

CHARACTER	ROLE ON-PAGE	ALLEGIANCE	LEVERAGE	WHAT THEY KNOW THAT MATTERS	STATUS AT CH. 22
Lorraine	Mercer front desk	The Mercers	The ledger	Counts watchers	Mercer building
Pell	Back Market salt vendor	Himself	Blended salt	Knows Isola by name after ch. 4	Back Market
Tiran Blackwood	Not on-page in chs. 1–22	○ OPEN in 3SL	○ OPEN in 3SL	See III.14 and III.18 for what FTE says about him	His cleanup after Remy's death is fixed (TCD-002)
The gang leader	Not on-page in chs. 1–22	○ OPEN	○ OPEN	○ OPEN	Kills Remy in the climax (TCD-063)

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE GANG LEADER · ○ OPEN

FIXED
He exists and he kills Remy with a mortal wound while Remy deliberately protects or rescues Melena (TCD-063).

UNDECIDED
Who he is, which gang, his motive, how he's introduced, and his fate. Whether he connects to Blue Circle, Blue Six, or the counterfeit route is not established.

WHY IT MATTERS
An antagonist who first appears in the climax will feel like weather. He needs at least one earlier shadow on the page.

DECIDE BY
Before drafting the chapter that introduces him.

WORKING SPACE · THE GANG LEADER

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-063; 3SL draft chs. 1–22;* 3SL Character Outlines *(full names and godbinding where the draft is silent).*

SEE ALSO VII.3 Cross-Book Character and Entity Index → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

PAIRED DOSSIER · PART III · 3 SHADOWMERE LANE / THE UNDERSIDE

III.14 MELENA AND REMY IN SHADOWMERE

Protect FTE's foundation while 3SL is drafted.

This is the foundation FTE stands on, and 3SL is still pouring it. Melena arrives in Shadowmere grieving, fire-sick, and furious at being kept, and Remy becomes the one person who can bring her down without trying to own her. Whatever 3SL does next has to end with Remy dead by the gang leader's hand and Melena carrying his death into FTE.

MELENA AS DRAFTED

LANE	CONTENT	STATUS
Identity	Remnia's Imperial Princess; Lucia's daughter; crimson hair; brown skin; eyes described as emerald or green throughout	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 3–4, 11, 21
Age	Tells Selah she's nineteen. Silas had guessed eighteen.	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 7, 11, 21
Grief	Her mother died "last winter," almost a year before ch. 21; Melena hasn't slept since before the memorial; Lucia "chose everything"; "I don't know who I am without my mother!"	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 7, 19, 21
Fire	Uncontrolled; charcoal spreads under her nails before it breaks; Hush takes away the warning and leaves the fire; she calls herself a Flamer	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 3, 5, 7, 11, 21
Who knows who she is	Dante, Camille, Silas, Mother Rae; Selah recognizes her face as Lucia's; she says "they know my name" and won't wait for them to give it to Remnia	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 3, 20–22
Belief about the Prayer	Lucia told her its name but couldn't perform it because Lucia "wasn't a Frost like my dad was"	Character belief. The Frost-only reading is superseded (TCD-057).
Unexplained	Blue Circle's clerk says she "got into my head somehow" to sell her full Hush	Clerk's claim; ○ OPEN

Remy as drafted. Locs, silver ear cuff, green coat, a messenger bag, a ward-thread bracelet he touches when anxious, mints he hands out like peace treaties. Ora owes him. His mother believes prayer can stop anything. He tells Melena he knows what it is to want one hour where somebody being dead doesn't touch you, and that Hush steals that hour and charges for it later. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 1, 7)

How Remy grounds her. He doesn't touch her unless she reaches for him. He asks her to name colors (silver wrapper, green coat, black shirt), then where she is, then who's in the room; he has her plant her heels; he taps six uneven beats on the floor; he keeps her mother's letter away from her hands until they cool. Each time, the fire lowers. By chapter 11 she's asleep against his shoulder; in chapter 9 she has asked him to stay until Rae comes; in chapter 22 he's the one who takes her through the corridor. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 7, 9, 11, 19, 22)

GUARDRAIL

Remy's gentleness isn't naivety. He knows a route no one else knows, keys it with his own blood, and recognizes marks Silas doesn't. Draft him as someone with his own history, not as Melena's support system.

What 3SL owes FTE. The FTE Beta has already drafted Melena's memory of Shadowmere, and 3SL has to either deliver it or deliberately change it (with FTE updated to match).

FTE BETA SAYS	WHERE 3SL STANDS
Remy calls Melena "Mira" and dies saying "I love you, Mira"	Not yet on-page; no nickname used in chs. 1–22
Tiran Blackwood nearly killed her in Shadowmere over a debt she didn't know existed, and is responsible for half the scars on her back	Tiran hasn't appeared
After the warehouse fire, Tiran grabbed her hair, slammed her head against brick, punched her ribs, and told her "This is on you!"	Undrafted; a candidate execution of TCD-002's fixed cleanup
Caelum says Tiran is in London Town "on a run for Maven"	Mother Rae is Maven; no Tiran link on-page yet
She recovered for months and couldn't wear heels for a long time	Compatible if the recovery took months inside a two-year gap; see the revision flag below

REVISION FLAG (FTE MANUSCRIPT)

"Months since the alley."

The interval is canon: 3SL happens about two years before the FTE/ADST window. ● CANON TCD-013. The FTE Beta line in which Melena thinks "It had been months since the alley" when she sees Tiran again doesn't compete with that ruling; it's drafted wording that needs revising to fit it. Same for "months of healing" if it's meant to cover the whole gap.

◇ CONFLICT

Melena's eyes.

3SL describes Melena's eyes as emerald or green throughout. The FTE Beta, ch. 8, says she hides "Lockwood amber eyes" with brown contacts. Appearance details are an open audit category, but this one is visible in both books.

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-009, TCD-013, TCD-043, TCD-057, TCD-063; 3SL draft chs. 1, 3–5, 7, 9, 11, 19–22; FTE Beta chs. 8–9 and the Remy memory passage.*

SEE ALSO III.15 Remy's Death: Beat Sheet and Memory Translation · **p.93**

IV.14 Melena Lockwood → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

IV.15 Caelum and Melena: The Leverage Ledger → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

NOTES · III.14

III.15 REMY'S DEATH: BEAT SHEET AND MEMORY TRANSLATION

Lock the objective event before it's drafted.

The gang leader kills Remy. Melena's Fire doesn't. She'll carry it as though it did, and FTE is allowed to let her, but this page keeps the forensic record apart from her guilt. ● CANON TCD-063

The event is fixed before it's drafted: Remy deliberately intervenes to protect or rescue Melena, and the gang leader mortally wounds him. Melena's escalating, uncontrolled Fire helps create the dangerous confrontation, but neither her Fire nor the later warehouse collapse is the lethal mechanism. After the wound she tries to save him and can't stop the bleeding. His death drives her Fire into full loss of control and the blaze and collapse follow. Tiran's cleanup follows that. ● CANON TCD-002, TCD-063

BEAT SHEET

STATUS	#	FIXED BEAT	OPEN CHOICES · DRAFTING SPACE
● CANON TCD-063	1	Melena's Fire escalates toward a dangerous confrontation	What sets it off; where; who else is present
● CANON TCD-063	2	The gang leader is part of the confrontation	Who he is; why he's there; his motive (III.13)
● CANON TCD-063	3	Remy deliberately intervenes to protect or rescue Melena	The exact action

STATUS	#	FIXED BEAT	OPEN CHOICES · DRAFTING SPACE
● CANON **TCD-063**	**4**	The gang leader mortally wounds Remy	Weapon and wound. The Beta's machete and severed artery are compatible candidates, not canon over the 3SL scene.
● CANON **TCD-063**	**5**	Melena tries to save him and can't stop the bleeding	How long it takes; what she tries
● CANON **TCD-002, TCD-063**	**6**	Remy dies	Final words (the Beta has "I love you, Mira")
● CANON **TCD-063**	**7**	His death drives her Fire into catastrophic loss of control	How big; who gets out
● CANON **as consequence, not cause of death (TCD-063)**	**8**	Blaze and collapse	Fire versus collapse proportions
● CANON **TCD-002**	**9**	Tiran's cleanup	Its form, its violence, and what it costs Melena

STATUS	#	FIXED BEAT	OPEN CHOICES · DRAFTING SPACE
○ OPEN	—	The gang leader's fate	
○ OPEN	—	Witnesses	Silas, Isola, Rhea, Mother Rae, anyone else?

The weapon slot, if the Beta's candidates are adopted. A severed major artery gives Melena seconds to minutes, not an hour. Once the weapon and wound are chosen, the realistic timeline for blood loss is a research question, not a canon question. ☐ RESEARCH — exsanguination timing and field pressure for the chosen wound.

CONTINUITY TRANSLATION

LAYER	CONTENT	STATUS
Objective event	Beats 1–9 above	● CANON TCD-002, TCD-063
Melena's FTE memory, as drafted in the Beta	She was on time; saw the machete flash; reached him before his knees hit the ground; pressed her palm over a severed artery that kept slipping; begged him to stay; "Maven's coming" when Maven wasn't; the warehouse door already closed; boots getting closer; "I love you, Mira"; his hand going slack; the warehouse wall catching, then the crates, then the rain burning; Tiran dragging her back, slamming her head against brick, punching her ribs, telling her "This is on you!" and "You set the whole godsdamn block on fire"	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT (FTE domain)
Melena's guilt	She feels causally responsible. FTE may portray that guilt freely.	● CANON TCD-063
Legacy framing	"Directly caused by Melena" (3SL *Character Outlines*)	~~LEGACY / SUPERSEDED~~ as forensic truth

LAYER	CONTENT	STATUS
Contradiction risk	If 3SL gives the gang leader a different weapon or the death happens away from an alley and warehouse, the Beta's flashback has to be revised to match 3SL. The objective killer can't change.	Watch

GUARDRAIL

Tiran's line "This is on you!" is what he says to her. It isn't the Companion's verdict. The forensic record stays with the gang leader.

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-009, TCD-063; FTE Beta (Remy memory passage);* 3SL Character Outlines *(Remy entry). Record: Remy Death Beat Sheet + Memory Translation.*

SEE ALSO III.14 Melena and Remy in Shadowmere · **p.90**

IV.14 Melena Lockwood → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

VII.10 Continuity Translation Pages → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

NOTES · III.15

III.16 SELAH AND THE ELDERS' PRAYER IN 3SL

Record the 3SL performance.

Selah performs the Elders' Prayer for Silas and Isola at her own dining table, with frost climbing her arms and six notes she's been humming since chapter 2. It keeps both of them alive, and it doesn't give Isola her leg back. ● CANON TCD-057; ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 20–21

PERFORMANCE RECORD

FIELD	WHAT THE PAGE SHOWS	STATUS
Performer	Selah Maris Wraithmoor	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Recipients	Isola (the dying leg) and Silas (breath and pulse), worked together through the tether	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Conditions	Rhea holds the deathwork below Selah's palm so it can't climb; Selah refuses to touch anything Camille did and looks "for the part of him still living"	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
How it presents	Cold that moves with each heartbeat; a pale web of frost following the black routes without joining them; a six-note hum pushed through Silas's palm	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Named	Melena recognizes it: "Elder's Prayer." Selah asks how she knows it.	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Effect on Isola	Torn muscle drawn toward the bone; blood reaches her foot; the bone stays broken; the dead channels don't come back; she can't walk	● CANON TCD-057; ■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Effect on Silas	His pulse answers on the fourth note, his breath on the sixth; when he stops breathing, her pressure brings him back; afterward his pulse holds on its own	● CANON recovery of living function, not resurrection (TCD-057)
Cost to Selah	Frost climbs past both elbows toward her shoulder for the first time; her hands go numb; her left fingers won't close; Silas makes her stop ("You go that far, I can't come get you")	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

III.16 · SELAH AND THE ELDERS' PRAYER IN 3SL CONTINUED

FIELD	WHAT THE PAGE SHOWS	STATUS
What it didn't do	"Mama hadn't closed him. She'd gotten his living body far enough from the ending to keep breathing beside it."	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

GUARDRAIL

Silas's breath and pulse returning under Selah's hands is recovery from active dying, not resurrection. The Prayer restores a viable living pattern; it can't reverse completed death or rebuild ruined anatomy. (TCD-057)

COPYEDIT FLAG (3SL MANUSCRIPT)

The Companion spelling is **Elders' Prayer**. Melena's line in the current draft reads "Elder's Prayer"; correct it in revision. This isn't an open canon question.

Knowledge on the page. Selah knows the working as a prayer and knows living blood ("I know what living blood feels like"), though Rhea points out she's never done this before. Melena knows the name from Lucia and believes it takes a Frost to perform. Selah knew Lucia well enough to mistake Melena for her. Whether Selah knows the Prayer's Remnian form, or its history, isn't shown. (■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT, chs. 20–21)

NOT THE SAME AS

Selah's performance and Katherine's later one for Atlas share an inherited working and an objective function, not a transmission. Nothing Selah does here echoes forward into FTE. (TCD-023, TCD-048)

SOURCE *TCD-023, TCD-048, TCD-057; 3SL draft chs. 2, 20–22.*

SEE ALSO II.14 The Elders' Prayer · **p.37**

IV.17 The Elders' Prayer in FTE → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

VII.7 Repeated Working and Ritual Registry → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

III.17 PLOT STATE AND KNOWLEDGE LEDGER

Separate what's written from what's planned.

This page separates what's written from what's owed. The left column is the book. Everything to its right is either fixed by a ruling or still a choice.

PLOT STATE

DRAFTED FACTS (CHS. 1–22)	RULED FUTURE ANCHORS	RECOVERABLE OUTLINE BEATS	OPEN SCENES
Melena in Mercer custody; Fire uncontrolled; Hush and blackroot episodes	Remy dies by the gang leader's wound while protecting Melena (TCD-063)	◌ POSSIBLE The outline's restrained separation and future promise, only after the romance line is crossed (TCD-044)	Where Remy and Melena's corridor goes
Asha's counterfeit route exposed; Sixth Ward audited; Micah's sponsorship stamped; Asha ordered to report at third bell	Melena's Fire goes catastrophic after his death; blaze and collapse (TCD-063)	No other outline beats can be listed; the outline isn't in this Project	Who fills Blue Six; what happens at Asha's third-bell appointment
Halflight Severance; Silas crosses into Ashvein under High Heresy	Tiran's cleanup (TCD-002)		How the Synod answers an unauthorized Graves transfer
The claim and the tether; Isola's leg ruined	Silas and Isola cross into explicit, consensual romance before the end, and don't end as a settled public couple (TCD-044)		The first major romantic scene; consent repair
Selah's Prayer; Selah's hands frost-damaged			Whether the tether can loosen enough for separate paths

DRAFTED FACTS (CHS. 1–22)	RULED FUTURE ANCHORS	RECOVERABLE OUTLINE BEATS	OPEN SCENES
Remy and Melena through the NEUTRAL TRANSIT corridor; Silas, Isola, Rhea hiding in the brake recess			The gang leader's introduction
The Graves mark on the Shroud; the shape at the door; the siblings' blood-route; Jude under Dante's eye			What Dante's hook means

KNOWLEDGE LEDGER

CHARACTER	THROUGH CH. 10	THROUGH CH. 15	THROUGH CH. 22
Silas	Melena's identity (ch. 3); the counterfeit matches Jerrick's token (ch. 9); Isola's name, by deduction (ch. 10)	Asha is the courier; the Shroud bore Dante's mark	What he did to Isola; that he can't close it; that Remy has a route he never mentioned
Isola	Asha's counterfeit and route strip (ch. 6); Silas's reputation; black three	Blue Six by name (ch. 10); the raid; a Shroud wanted the name strip she took	Her name is on his wrist; she can feel him and the dead; she doesn't know who Lucia is
Melena	Her mother's letter (contents not shown to anyone else)	Lucia worked in Shadowmere and got people out (ch. 11)	Selah knew Lucia; the Prayer's name; the station's numbers are Remnian
Remy	Ora's den; Melena's grief	Grounding works on her	The station; its access phrase; the green mark

III.17 · PLOT STATE AND KNOWLEDGE LEDGER

CONTINUED

CHARACTER	THROUGH CH. 10	THROUGH CH. 15	THROUGH CH. 22
Tiran	Not on-page	Not on-page	Not on-page
Dante	Melena's identity; Lucia's death came as news to him	Asha's role; Isola is Rae's goddaughter	Jude answered a voice he couldn't hear

GUARDRAIL

Nobody in 3SL knows what FTE, ADST, or the rulings know. Nothing in chs. 1–22 shows anyone knowing that Katherine Nicholas is Melena's paternal half-sister, that Elias Lockwood lives a second life as Thorne, or what Convergence is. Don't let a 3SL scene act on any of them.

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-040, TCD-044, TCD-063; 3SL draft chs. 1–22.*

SEE ALSO III.19 3SL Draft-Forward Packet · **p.104**

VII.5 Cross-Land Knowledge Matrix → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

NOTES · III.17

III.18 HANDOFF INTO FTE AND THE NEXT SHADOWMERE BOOK

Show what 3SL passes forward.

3SL ends about two years before FTE and ADST begin (TCD-013), and it hands forward more than it resolves. The interval is canon at about two years; the FTE Beta's "months since the alley" line is a manuscript revision flag, not a competing chronology (III.14).

THREAD	3SL END STATE	PICKED UP WHERE
Melena	Grieving Remy; feels causally responsible for his death; Fire carrying the trauma; her trust in official history broken by what Shadowmere showed her	FTE: her investigation of Katherine starts because 3SL destroyed her trust in official history (TCD-050); FTE portrays her guilt (TCD-063)
Remy's death	Objective: the gang leader's wound	FTE memory (III.15); Melena's first love per the *Character Outlines*
Tiran	Performs the cleanup (TCD-002)	FTE: London Town's Bishop; Melena's history with him; advises and operationalizes the forfeit (TCD-042, TCD-052)
Mother Rae (Maven)	Knows Melena and the Shadowmere network	FTE: Caelum says Tiran is running errands for Maven (Beta)
Caelum	Not on-page in 3SL	TCD-043 gives Melena "Shadowmere knowledge" as leverage in their alliance; where that alliance begins isn't placed. ○ OPEN
Silas and Isola	Explicitly romantic, not a settled public couple, on separate immediate paths (TCD-044); the tether's state ○ OPEN	The next Shadowmere installment, if it carries them ○ OPEN
The two-year interval	Background life continues	TCD-054 allows the next Shadowmere character's continuing two-year life to predate page one

III.18 · HANDOFF INTO FTE AND THE NEXT SHADOWMERE BOOK

CONTINUED

THREAD	3SL END STATE	PICKED UP WHERE
The next Shadowmere installment	Title open; follows the 3 / 5 / 7 numbering pattern (TCD-014)	Begins directly after FTE/ADST and substantially overlaps TSWK (TCD-054)

OPEN DEVELOPMENT · THE NEXT SHADOWMERE BOOK · ○ OPEN

FIXED
It follows the 3 / 5 / 7 pattern; it begins directly after FTE/ADST in a rolling window and overlaps TSWK (TCD-014, TCD-054).

UNDECIDED
Title; protagonist or protagonists; plot engine; which 3SL threads it inherits.

WHY IT MATTERS
3SL's final chapters decide what's left open for it.

DECIDE BY
Safe to defer until 3SL's final chapter is drafted.

WORKING SPACE · THE NEXT SHADOWMERE BOOK

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-013, TCD-014, TCD-042, TCD-043, TCD-044, TCD-050, TCD-052, TCD-054, TCD-063; FTE Beta ch. 8.*

SEE ALSO IV.14 Melena Lockwood → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

VII.1 Master Synchronization Timeline → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

III.19 3SL DRAFT-FORWARD PACKET

The pages that sit open beside the manuscript.

These are the pages that sit open beside chapter 23. If an open question doesn't touch the next scene, it doesn't stop the next scene.

Stop point. Remy and Melena are through the NEUTRAL TRANSIT corridor, out of sight. Silas, Isola, and Rhea are in a brake recess in the loading cut, twelve feet from a closing wall, with Synod gold reaching the spot where Remy's blood was. Micah and Tevin are watching the Wraithmoor house; Omari stayed; Asha's third-bell appointment is pending. (ch. 22)

BODIES

CHARACTER	CONDITION AT STOP POINT
Silas	Right hand black, numb, useless; left leg weak; dead riding his chain on a grave nail; breath and pulse tied to Isola's
Isola	Right leg braced and ruined; crutch under her left arm; can't bear normal weight; tethered
Rhea	Palm split and bleeding from holding Graves marks; carrying the supply bag
Selah	Hands frost-damaged past the elbows; left fingers won't close
Remy	Burned arm; freshly cut palm
Melena	Fire barely held; hair catching at the ends

GRAVESHAND NON-NEGOTIABLES

- Opening it gives the dead a route to him. They come and they follow.
- Removing a claim doesn't remove damage.
- Funeral terms over his work travel back to him.
- His siblings can hear him through the blood-route when it's open, and Dante has noticed.
- Rhea's standing threat: open it again and she'll put him in a coffin until Camille can close it.

TETHER NON-NEGOTIABLES

- Not consent, not romance (TCD-044).
- Separation hurts both; touch relieves both.
- They move as one: crutch first, then her left foot, then his step.
- She wants it off and has said what he did isn't okay.

MELENA AND REMY

- Remy is alive and must die by the gang leader's wound while protecting Melena (TCD-063). The corridor is the road there.
- Melena calls herself a Flamer and her Fire is still uncontrolled.
- FTE remembers an alley, a warehouse, a machete, a severed artery, "Mira," and Tiran's violent cleanup. Deliver it or revise FTE on purpose.

SCENE-LEVEL OPEN CHOICES FOR CH. 23

CHOICE	TOUCHES CH. 23?
What the Synod's gold does at the recess	Yes
Why Silas, Isola, and Rhea couldn't enter the station	Likely
Whose POV follows Remy and Melena, if any	Yes
Where the corridor goes	Yes, if ch. 23 follows them
What Dante's hook on the Shroud means	Only if it's revealed here
Asha's third-bell appointment	Only if ch. 23 returns to Sixth Ward

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-044, TCD-063; 3SL draft chs. 15–22; FTE Beta (memory passage).*

SEE ALSO

III.8 Graveshand, Deathwork, and Severance · **p.67**

III.11 The Tether (involuntary track) · **p.79**

III.12 Silas and Isola (voluntary track) · **p.82**

III.15 Remy's Death: Beat Sheet and Memory Translation · **p.93**

NOTES · III.19

III.20 3SL OPEN DEVELOPMENT

Every open 3SL item in one place.

Every open 3SL item in one place, sorted by when it has to be decided.

ITEM	FIXED	UNDECIDED	DECIDE BY
The NEUTRAL TRANSIT station	Drafted as it stands (ch. 22)	Destination; builder; the cut fifth seal; why the others can't pass; Remy's knowledge, access phrase, and wrist mark	Before ch. 23
The gang leader	He kills Remy (TCD-063)	Identity, gang, motive, introduction, fate	Before the chapter that introduces him
Remy's death specifics	Beats 1–9 in III.15	Action, weapon, wound, witnesses, final words, fire/collapse proportions	Before the climax draft
Tiran in 3SL	His cleanup (TCD-002)	When he first appears; his relationship to Maven; how violent the cleanup is on-page	Before the climax draft
Silas/Isola romance	TCD-044 landing	First major scene, initiator, intimacy, consent repair, final language	Before their first scene alone and conscious
The tether	Nonconsensual; not consent (TCD-044)	Whether it loosens, breaks, or carries forward; long-term cost	Before the climax sequence
Graveshand limits	The five laws (author ruling, 2026-08-22); drafted behaviors in III.8	Any limit not yet shown on-page; whether Graveshand can be closed	When a new Severance tests a limit
Dante's hook on the Shroud; the shape at the door	Drafted (chs. 15, 17–18)	What they mean	Before Dante's next on-page scene with Silas
The siblings' blood-route seals	Drafted (chs. 16–18)	Their origin; why Dante fears them opening	Safe to defer

ITEM	FIXED	UNDECIDED	DECIDE BY
Blue Six and the counterfeit source	Drafted route and compound (chs. 9–13)	Who fills it; how high it goes	Before Asha's plotline resolves
Asha's third-bell appointment	Ordered (ch. 12)	Whether she goes; what happens	When the draft returns to Sixth Ward
Which building is the safehouse	◇ CONFLICT chs. 1, 3, 11, 17	One building or two	The safehouse's next appearance
Melena's eye color	◇ CONFLICT 3SL green/emerald versus FTE amber	Which one	Next revision of either book
Tier depths and cross-section	TCD-026	Depths, boundaries	Safe to defer
Remnia–Underside crossing	Exists (TCD-027)	Coordinate; arrival tier	Remnia map review
Six Disciplines terminology	Worldbuilding names as the working hierarchy (III.7)	Lamentcraft/Lamentchant; Rootwhisperers/Root-Listeners	Safe to defer
Calendar	None ruled	The *Character Outlines* carry birth years (Silas 2070, Isola 2073); no ruling adopts them as the calendar anchor	With the master timeline (VII.1)
Next Shadowmere installment	3 / 5 / 7 pattern; rolling window (TCD-014, TCD-054)	Title, focus, engine	After 3SL's final chapter

III.20 · 3SL OPEN DEVELOPMENT

CONTINUED

ITEM	FIXED	UNDECIDED	DECIDE BY

MANUSCRIPT REVISION FLAGS (NOT OPEN CANON)

FLAG	CONTROLLING ANSWER	REVISE WHERE
"Months since the alley"	About two years ● CANON TCD-013	FTE Beta, Tiran reunion scene
"Elder's Prayer"	Elders' Prayer	3SL draft, Melena's line (ch. 20)

SOURCE *TCD-002, TCD-014, TCD-026, TCD-027, TCD-044, TCD-054, TCD-063; 3SL draft chs. 1–22; FTE Beta;* 3SL Character Outlines *; Production Master III.8.*

SEE ALSO VII.12 Open Canon Queue → 3SL concordance · **p.123**

NOTES · III.20

III.20 3SL OPEN DEVELOPMENT

GUARDRAIL

An open question that doesn't touch the next scene doesn't stop drafting.

OPEN STAYS OPEN.
Each item gets its own working pages. Set a Decide-by only when drafting forces one.

ITEM	WHAT'S FIXED	DECIDE BY	SAFE TO DEFER	DECIDED	WORK ON
A · Remy-death specifics	● CANON TCD-002 · 009 · 063		☐	☐	p.112–115
B · Romance specifics	● CANON TCD-044		☐	☐	p.116–117
C · Tier depths	● CANON ■ DRAFTED ◪ SUPPORTED TCD-025 · 026 · 3SL ch. 10 · 3SL Full Worldbuilding		☐	☐	p.118–119
D · Crossing placement	● CANON TCD-017 · 027		☐	☐	p.120
E · Next Shadowmere book	● CANON II.16 · III.18		☐	☐	p.121–122

III.20 · WORKING SECTION

CONTINUED

ADDED IN DRAFTING · NAME IT, DATE IT, GIVE IT A PAGE

ITEM	WHAT'S FIXED	DECIDE BY	SAFE TO DEFER	DECIDED	WORK ON
F·			☐	☐	
G·			☐	☐	
H·			☐	☐	
I·			☐	☐	
J·			☐	☐	
K·			☐	☐	

RESOLVED ITEMS MOVE TO APPENDIX A WITH A LOG NO.

APPENDIX A · P.129

WORKING SECTION · 3 OF 13 · ITEM A

III.20 REMY'S DEATH: THE SCENE

● CANON

FIXED

The nine fixed beats in III.15. Work inside them; nothing here moves a fixed beat.

TCD-002 · 009 · 063

III.15 · p.93

○ OPEN

A1 · EXACT RESCUE ACTION

Beat 3 is fixed: Remy deliberately intervenes to protect her. What exactly does he do, and what does it cost him in the moment?

TIED TO
Beat 3

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN
◌ POSSIBLE

A2 · WEAPON AND WOUND

Beat 4: the gang leader mortally wounds him. Beta's machete/major-artery detail is a compatible candidate only. Keep it, change it, or replace it, and say why.

TIED TO
Beat 4 · Beta candidate

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

A3 · FINAL WORDS

Beat 6: he dies. Does he speak? Draft the words, or the silence, and note what Melena carries of it into FTE.

TIED TO
Beat 6 · Memory Translation, VII.10

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

WORKING SECTION · 5 OF 13 · ITEM A

III.20 REMY'S DEATH: AROUND THE SCENE

○ OPEN

A4 · ATTACKER MOTIVE

The gang leader is the climax antagonist. Why does he act at this moment, and does anyone on the page ever learn why?

TIED TO
III.13 · gang leader's motive

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

A5 · WITNESSES

Who sees Remy die? List each witness, where they stand, and what they saw versus what they were told.

TIED TO
III.15 open · witnesses

VII.5 → 3SL concordance · p.123

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

A6 · ATTACKER FATE

What happens to the gang leader after Remy dies?

TIED TO
III.13 · gang leader's fate

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

● CANON

A7 · FIRE/COLLAPSE PROPORTIONS

Beat 8: blaze/collapse is not the fatal mechanism. How much of the scene does it take, and what does it destroy?

TIED TO
Beat 8 · TCD-063

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

III.20 ROMANCE SPECIFICS

● CANON

FIXED · THE RULED LANDING

Explicit, mutual, consensual physical romance before the end, without a settled public-couple ending.

TCD-044

III.12 · p.82

III.11 · p.79

GUARDRAIL

The tether is never evidence of romance or consent.

○ OPEN

B1 · CONSENT REPAIR

The voluntary track runs through acknowledgment of the violation and choices restored. What does repair look like on the page, and where does it happen?

TIED TO
III.12 · consent repair

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

B2 · FIRST MAJOR ROMANTIC SCENE · INITIATOR · INTIMACY LEVEL

Where does the first major romantic scene fall, who initiates, and how far does the page go?

TIED TO III.12 · first scene, initiator, intimacy level

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

○ OPEN

B3 · FINAL RELATIONSHIP LANGUAGE

No settled public-couple ending. What do they call what they are by the last page?

TIED TO III.12 · final language

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

WORKING SECTION · 9 OF 13 · ITEM C

III.20 TIERS AND THE CROSSING

C · Tier depths

III.3 · p.49

● CANON	The Underside is vertically tiered and attached to the Zenithia side of Remnia. Crownlight and Dawnveil are above-ground/surface tiers, and the nation is fully underground by Ironcross.	TCD-025 · TCD-026
■ DRAFTED	The Underside has nine tiers; Halflight's old route board lists all nine in order.	3SL ch. 10
◪ SUPPORTED	Tier functions and other worldbuilding detail where not independently drafted or ruled.	3SL Full Worldbuilding
○ OPEN	Exact elevations and depths; tier boundaries.	

TIER (DRAFTED ORDER)	SURFACE / UNDERGROUND	DEPTH, BOUNDARY, WHAT THE DRAFT NEEDS	ON-PAGE CH.
1. Crownlight	Surface-level		
2. Dawnveil	Surface-level		
3. Ironcross	Fully subterranean by this tier		
4. Stoneveil	Underground		
5. Lowtorch	Underground		
6. Ashvein	Underground		

TIER (DRAFTED ORDER)	SURFACE / UNDERGROUND	DEPTH, BOUNDARY, WHAT THE DRAFT NEEDS	ON-PAGE CH.
7. Shadowmere	Underground		
8. Gravebend	Underground		
9. Nightroot	Underground		

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

WORKING SECTION · 11 OF 13 · ITEM D

III.20 TIERS AND THE CROSSING

D · Crossing placement

II.3 · p.29 | III.6 · p.60

● CANON	The current Remnia–Underside crossing near the London Town / Old Prosperity / Alea no-man's-land. Routes are physical-magical transit through real passages; never portals.	TCD-017 · TCD-027
○ OPEN	Crossing coordinate; arrival tier (Shadowmere Tier 7 is unconfirmed); the unresolved transit route at the manuscript stop point.	

WHERE IT COMES OUT, AND HOW THEY GET THROUGH IT AT THE STOP POINT

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

WORKING SECTION · 12 OF 13 · ITEM E · PLOT ARCHITECTURE

III.20 THE NEXT SHADOWMERE BOOK

● CANON	TSWK and the next Shadowmere book in a rolling handoff directly after, overlapping substantially.	II.16 · TCD-013 · 014 · 024 · 054
○ OPEN	Next Shadowmere title and plot engine.	III.18
○ OPEN	**E1 · TITLE** The pattern is 3 / 5 / 7. List candidates.	TIED TO II.16 · title pattern
○ OPEN	**E2 · PLOT ENGINE** What pressure drives the next book? It opens in the rolling window beside TSWK, so start from what 3SL leaves unresolved.	TIED TO III.18 · plot engine

☐ SAFE TO DEFER DECIDE BY _____ ☐ DECIDED LOG _____ DATE _____

E3 · WHAT 3SL HANDS FORWARD III.18 · P.102

THREAD	3SL END STATE	PICKED UP WHERE
Melena's state entering FTE		
Tiran's aftermath function		
Silas and Isola's separate immediate paths		
The two-year interval		

CONCORDANCE · CONTINUITY ROOM · 3SL SLICE

CONTINUITY ROOM: 3SL CONCORDANCE

VII·3SL

Where this volume carries the 3SL information behind each Continuity Room pointer.

The full Companion's Continuity Room (Part VII) and the FTE dossier (Part IV) aren't printed in this volume. Every page here that points into them resolves to this table. The middle column is the Production Master's description of the full section; the right column names where the 3SL information already sits in these pages.

FULL COMPANION SECTION	WHAT IT HOLDS (PRODUCTION MASTER)	3SL INFORMATION IN THIS VOLUME
VII.1 **Master Synchronization Timeline**	One grid: Relative point | 3SL | FTE | ADST | TSWK | Next Shadowmere | Later books | Cross-land consequence | Who knows; four bands per book (Background Activation, Narrative Opening, Climax, Resolution); the two-year interval; Elias's double-life span; ADST T0.	3SL and next-Shadowmere rows of the four-band table (II.16); the handoff table (III.18); the 3SL bands tracker on the following page. II.16 · p.40 III.18 · p.102
VII.2 **Event Chronology vs Information Chronology**	Information-delay record Event | Witness | First record | Route/communication path | Travel delay | Recipient | Version received | When they act. Worked row: Elias's missed return.	Knowledge ledger by chapter (III.17); drafted cross-land knowledge (II.4). III.17 · p.99 II.4 · p.31

FULL COMPANION SECTION	WHAT IT HOLDS (PRODUCTION MASTER)	3SL INFORMATION IN THIS VOLUME
VII.3 **Cross-Book Character and Entity Index**	Name | Appearances | Objective identity | Known identities | Who knows each | Allegiance | Current objective | Cross-book function | Open. Priority rows: Melena, Tiran, Caelum, Elias/Thorne, Nightmare organization, ancient Nightmare, the Leviathan. Includes the Caelum Cross-Book Agenda + Network Dossier (every appearance: location, local and long-term wants, counterparties, knowledge limits, debts, gains).	Supporting cast table (III.13); Melena and Remy (III.14). III.13 · p.86 III.14 · p.90
VII.4 **Route and Transit Timeline**	Who crosses which route when; route class; what the crossing costs; who can trace it.	Drafted routes by class and who knows routes (III.6); the one confirmed crossing (II.3). III.6 · p.60 II.3 · p.29
VII.5 **Cross-Land Knowledge Matrix**	Nation | Class | Institution | Network | Character | Time | Knows | Believes | Hidden | Status against the six knowledge levels. Priority actors: Silas, Isola, Melena, Remy, Tiran; Katherine, Atlas, Maxim, Michelle, Tobias, Sanctum; Reverie, Cassius, Caelum, Elias/Thorne, House Aether, High Council; Azrine, Levi, Tavian, Jori, House Dren, Skyhold.	Seed knowledge table (II.4); route knowledge (III.6); knowledge ledger (III.17); the 3SL knowledge tracker in this section. II.4 · p.31 III.6 · p.60 III.17 · p.99
VII.7 **Repeated Working and Ritual Registry**	The Elders' Prayer: objective function, cultural forms, Selah's and Katherine's performances, activation conditions, death threshold, what it can't do, no direct transfer.	The Elders' Prayer can/can't table and the two performances (II.14); Selah's performance record (III.16). II.14 · p.37 III.16 · p.97

FULL COMPANION SECTION	WHAT IT HOLDS (PRODUCTION MASTER)	3SL INFORMATION IN THIS VOLUME
VII.10 **Continuity Translation Pages**	Objective event | First-book depiction | Later memory | Institutional/public version | Reader knowledge | Contradiction risk. Priority pages: Remy's death (3SL vs Melena's FTE memory); Elias missing vs Thorne deteriorating; Katherine's lineage (truth vs Crown/Sanctum/public records); House Dren Anchor history vs official mythology.	Continuity translation for Remy's death (III.15); what 3SL owes FTE (III.14). III.15 · p.93 III.14 · p.90
VII.12 **Open Canon Queue**	Every open item sorted into: blocks current drafting · needed before a climax · needed before a later book · Companion-only clarification · research-required · safe to defer.	Every open 3SL item (III.20 reference table) and the working queue (III.20 working section). III.20 · p.107
IV.14 **Melena Lockwood**	Her FTE self after 3SL; Remy grief and memory; Shadowmere knowledge; Elias investigation; Katherine suspicion; survival choice. GUARDRAIL: not FTE's designated villain.	Melena in Shadowmere; her FTE memory of Remy's death; her state entering FTE. III.14 · p.90 III.15 · p.93 III.18 · p.102
IV.15 **Caelum and Melena: Leverage Ledger**	Caelum's assets (Elias access, Somnorian intelligence, routes, networks); Melena's (Remnian and royal access, Tournament intelligence, Shadowmere knowledge); threats, concessions, withheld intelligence; "asset" as his framing.	Caelum's report of Tiran and Maven (III.14); Caelum's alliance leverage as handed forward (III.18). III.14 · p.90 III.18 · p.102
IV.17 **The Elders' Prayer in FTE**	Independent performance for Atlas; Remnian cultural form; the no-resurrection boundary.	The Prayer's two independent performances (II.14); Selah's 3SL performance (III.16). II.14 · p.37 III.16 · p.97

VII.1 · 3SL BANDS · RECORD: TANDEM MASTER SYNCHRONIZATION TIMELINE II.16 · P.40

Rows reproduced from II.16. The working columns take dates and anchors as drafting fixes them.

BOOK	BAND	AS RULED / OPEN (II.16)	WORKING DATE · ANCHOR · CH.
3SL	Background activation	○ OPEN	
3SL	Narrative opening	About two years before the FTE/ADST window; exact date ○ OPEN	
3SL	Climax	Remy's death and Melena's catastrophic Fire; Tiran's cleanup follows (TCD-002, TCD-063)	
3SL	Resolution	Silas and Isola on separate immediate paths (TCD-044)	
Next Shadowmere book	Background activation	May predate page one, including its character's continuing two-year life (TCD-054)	
Next Shadowmere book	Narrative opening	Directly after FTE/ADST; overlaps TSWK substantially (TCD-054)	
Next Shadowmere book	Climax	○ OPEN	
Next Shadowmere book	Resolution	○ OPEN	

VII.5 · 3SL KNOWLEDGE SEED · RECORD: KNOWLEDGE OF THE OTHER LANDS MATRIX

II.4 · P.31

3SL rows reproduced from II.4. Every row is dated to its chapter; blank rows extend the matrix as drafting adds knowledge.

CHARACTER	CHAPTER	KNOWLEDGE ON-PAGE	LEVEL	STATUS
Silas Graves	3SL ch. 3	Reads Melena's fire as proof she's Remnian; believes nobody born in the Underside carries fire	Functional (as belief)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Silas Graves	3SL ch. 11	Knows Somnoria by name; hopes Melena won't ask what it is	Existence	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Remy	3SL ch. 11	Names Somnoria in a joke about distance	Existence; the joke implies he thinks it's far	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Dante Mercer	3SL ch. 3	Knows Melena is Remnia's Imperial Princess and Lucia's daughter; expects Remnia to treat her discovery as an act of war	Functional (Remnian politics); historical (personal, through Lucia)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT
Mother Rae (Maven Renae Vellum)	3SL chs. 3, 11	Knew Lucia; Lucia's final letter gave Melena Rae's name and a route phrase that should've been dead twenty years	Route (at least one route phrase)	■ CURRENT DRAFTED TEXT

CONTINUITY ROOM · 3SL CONCORDANCE

CONTINUED

CHARACTER	CHAPTER	KNOWLEDGE ON-PAGE	LEVEL	STATUS

APPENDIX · STATUS & PROVENANCE SHEET

A CANON DECISION LOG: 3SL SLICE

Every author ruling this volume cites, reproduced from the audit's Canon Decision Log.

50 rulings are cited in this volume. Each row is reproduced from the Tandem Source Authority Audit — Working Record (Sep 26, 2026). Rulings this volume doesn't cite appear in the full Companion's Appendix A.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-001 2026-09-04	**Controlling FTE manuscript generation** FTE/Shared	Beta is the controlling prose generation. Chapters 31–39 are usable new-development material, but all content outside the Beta must be rewritten/integrated before it becomes canon.	SUPERSEDES FTE 2025 FINAL as prose authority; all older manuscript generations DOWNSTREAM Future FTE audits distinguish usable planning/development from canonized prose. No unwritten Beta-era ending is assumed canon.
TCD-002 2026-09-04	**3SL authority beyond drafted ch. 22** 3SL/FTE	Manuscript controls drafted events. Remy's death and Tiran's cleanup remain fixed; all other outline beats are provisional.	SUPERSEDES Outline as controlling chapter map DOWNSTREAM Remy's fate and Tiran's aftermath function stay canon; remaining structure and Silas/Isola ending require fresh development.
TCD-003 2026-09-04	**ADST authority beyond drafted ch. 19** ADST/Shared	Hybrid: current material controls the opening; the older plan retains the Prism, Nightmare, conduit climax, and sequel setup.	SUPERSEDES Older plan's superseded early execution DOWNSTREAM Later ADST architecture may use the retained climax/endgame, but must be bridged from the current manuscript generation.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-004 2026-09-04	**Graveshand/Deathwork classification** 3SL/Shared	Graveshand is inherited Graves-family magic outside the formal Six Disciplines. Deathwork is the broader category of ending-magic/effects that Graveshand can perceive, manipulate, sever, redirect, or create.	SUPERSEDES Any treatment of Graveshand as one of the formal Six Disciplines DOWNSTREAM The Companion must distinguish a formal discipline system from inherited exceptional magic and define Deathwork by function rather than institutional classification.
TCD-008 2026-09-04	**Challenge Four identity** FTE	The Conduit Trials replaces Burden and Bonds as the current Challenge Four concept. Its mechanics remain current for now, but “The Conduit Trials” is a working title; the final canon name is open.	SUPERSEDES Burden and Bonds as current Challenge Four DOWNSTREAM Mechanics may be audited now; naming must remain flagged rather than canonized.
TCD-009 2026-09-04	**FTE endgame anchors** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Retain Atlas’s deterioration and the Selah → Katherine prayer parallel; Old Prosperity wins because London Town forfeits after Challenge Six; retain the Katherine–Melena sister reveal and Katherine’s hidden elemental exposure; retire Minho’s assumed death and all “Melena was the villain” framing. 3SL controls the factual memory of Remy’s death and Melena’s fire loss-of-control event.	SUPERSEDES Minho’s mandatory death; Melena-as-villain framing; generic breakdown handing Katherine victory; contradictory FTE memories of 3SL; Atlas’s deterioration as an isolated accident DOWNSTREAM TCD-034, TCD-042, and TCD-049–052 now govern the Conqueror, forfeit, elemental classification, reveal architecture, Atlas origin, and Maxim’s authority. Prayer transmission is clarified by TCD-048. Minho’s arc, detailed climax mechanics, recovery/consequences, and unused Seventh remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-010 2026-09-04	**Remnian timeline authority** FTE/Shared	Construct a new canonical Remnian timeline. Existing Remnian timelines are reference/source material only and do not independently control chronology.	SUPERSEDES Every existing timeline's claim to global chronology authority DOWNSTREAM Timeline facts must be rebuilt from current manuscripts and explicit rulings, with conflicts surfaced rather than blended.
TCD-012 2026-09-04	**TSWK ending authority** TSWK/Shared	TSWK's ending is open. No existing ending concept controls. A later hybrid or different resolution may be developed after understanding what 3SL, FTE, and ADST hand into TSWK.	SUPERSEDES Old Cael/Levi descent ending as a fixed destination DOWNSTREAM Companion architecture must label all TSWK end-state claims as possible until ruled.
TCD-013 2026-09-04	**3SL/FTE/ADST chronology** 3SL/FTE/ADST	3SL occurs approximately two years before the main concurrent period. ADST begins when Elias goes missing; FTE begins a couple of weeks later. FTE and ADST then run largely concurrently and end around the same time without requiring chapter-level lockstep.	SUPERSEDES Any sequence placing ADST wholly after FTE or requiring chapters to synchronize one-for-one DOWNSTREAM Cross-book appearances, information transfer, travel, and consequences must respect the shared active window.
TCD-014 2026-09-04	**Shadowmere continuation and TSWK** 3SL/TSWK/Shared	TSWK is contemporaneous with the book that follows 3SL. Shadowmere books follow a 3 / 5 / 7 numbering pattern. The next title is open.	SUPERSEDES Any assumption that TSWK is automatically concurrent with 3SL itself or that the old Shadowmere series titles survive DOWNSTREAM TCD-054 now places the pair in a rolling window directly after FTE/ADST. The next Shadowmere address/title remains open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-015 2026-09-05	**Physical relationship of the four settings** All four	Remnia, Somnoria, Thalara, and the Underside exist in one physical world as separate nations/territories. Extreme isolation, magical boundaries, restricted routes, and controlled knowledge make “world” or “realm” valid in-world language, not literal cosmology.	SUPERSEDES Literal separate-planet, parallel-universe, or dimension readings of legacy lore DOWNSTREAM The Companion must distinguish physical reality, political reality, cultural perception, and magical/travel reality. Irreconcilable separate-world claims become Legacy.
TCD-016 2026-09-05	**Knowledge of the other lands** All four	Awareness varies by nation, class, institution, profession, network, person, and time. Existence, location, functional, route, historical, and true Tandem knowledge are distinct levels and cannot be inferred from one another.	SUPERSEDES Any universal rule that all populations either know or do not know the other lands DOWNSTREAM Build a time-sensitive Knowledge of the Other Lands Matrix tracking teaching, belief, official claims, suppression, rumor, institutional knowledge, exceptional characters, errors, acquisition dates, and source status.
TCD-017 2026-09-05	**Nature and scale of routes** 3SL/TSWK/Shared	Routes are magically enabled transit through real physical passages. They may serve local, tier, restricted/institutional, underground/smuggling, boundary-crossing, or neutral-transit functions. Cross-land routes breach barriers, distance, or concealed geography—not dimensions—and not every route has every capability.	SUPERSEDES Dimensional-portal cosmology; assumption that any route can reach any land DOWNSTREAM Build a Route Classification System tracking origin, controller, knowledge, opening requirements, stability, destination, cost/risk, traceability, traveler knowledge, and alternate names; connect it to TCD-016.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-019 2026-09-05	**Oneiros Prism's primary function** ADST/Shared	The Prism is a major cross-land artifact created to maintain boundaries, balance, or structural separation among the four lands. Somnorian dream infrastructure, conduit stabilization, and network regulation are later applications, not its original purpose.	SUPERSEDES Somnoria-centric treatment of Dream Network regulation as the Prism's complete original purpose DOWNSTREAM Define its original four-land function, whether it belonged to a larger system, why it fragmented, each piece's independent role, and the consequences of reunion. Somnorian interpretations may be accurate but incomplete.
TCD-021 2026-09-05	**Somnorian governing structure** ADST/Shared	The High Council is Somnoria's national governing body. The four Dream Houses hold representation and political power within it. The Dream Master's Guild regulates professional dreamwalking and related magic.	SUPERSEDES Any single institution's blanket supremacy across national governance, House politics, and professional magic DOWNSTREAM Build a Somnorian Institutional Power Map defining authority, regulation, punishment, overlap, and competition among Council, Houses, and Guild.
TCD-023 2026-09-05	**Elders' Prayer relationship** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Selah and Katherine perform the same inherited Elders' Prayer/magical working through different cultural language, terminology, and ritual expression. This is intentional cross-book repetition. Direct performance-to-performance causation was initially left open and is excluded by TCD-048.	SUPERSEDES Unrelated/coincidental-ritual reading; automatic direct-causation reading DOWNSTREAM Trace the prayer's origin, transmission, divergence, teaching, mechanics, costs, cultural names, and possible survival in Somnoria/Thalara. Katherine need not know Selah, the Underside origin, or the full history.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-024 2026-09-05	**TSWK/next Shadowmere synchronization** 3SL/FTE/ADST/TSWK	TSWK and the next Shadowmere novel occur in the same general period. Their exact relationship to FTE and ADST was initially open and is fixed at macro level by TCD-054.	SUPERSEDES Any fixed placement of the pair against FTE/ADST before later ruling DOWNSTREAM Build a master event-anchor timeline with separate activation, opening, climax, resolution, and delayed-information dates; TCD-054 establishes the direct rolling handoff.
TCD-025 2026-09-09	**Tandem macro geography** All four	The four lands occupy multiple major landmasses/regions in one world. Remnia and Somnoria are separate continental landmasses with ocean between them. Underside attaches to the Zenithia side/corner of Remnia's broader geography. Primarily underwater Thalara lies farther outward in the island/sea region. Spain/France/Italy/Greek-islands comparisons describe relative placement only, never real borders, scale, climate, culture, or coastlines.	SUPERSEDES One-continent assumptions; literal copying of real-world geography; separate-world cosmology DOWNSTREAM Build the Tandem Macro Geography Map and overlay physical and magical travel. Coastlines, landmass/ocean names, scale, distances, islands, and borders remain open.
TCD-026 2026-09-09	**Underside vertical geography** 3SL/FTE/Shared	The Underside is a vertically tiered nation beginning at/near the surface off Zenithia's side of Remnia and descending underground. Crownlight and Dawnveil are above-ground/surface-level tiers. By Ironcross, the descent is fully subterranean; lower tiers continue deeper. "Underside" names the descent-organized civilization even though its highest tiers are not literally underground.	SUPERSEDES Flat buried-continent model; assumption that every Underside tier is underground DOWNSTREAM Build a vertical cross-section fixing tier elevations/depths, surface transition, Zenithia relationship, and route/lift/rail descent.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-027 2026-09-09	**Echo Gate and current Remnia–Underside access** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	The singular sealed Echo Gate is Legacy. Its seal, spiral/mirrored glyph, or ancient-crossing imagery may be recovered later only as [P]. Independently, a current Remnia–Shadowmere/Underside crossing exists near the London Town edge/no-man's-land associated with London Town, Old Prosperity, and Alea. The canonical Remnia map will control its precise provincial coordinate once reviewed.	SUPERSEDES Echo Gate as established crossing; automatic inheritance of its lore; guessed precise map coordinate or arrival tier DOWNSTREAM Add the known entrance to the Route Map after reviewing the Remnia map. Exact border placement and whether it arrives directly in Shadowmere Tier 7 remain open.
TCD-028 2026-09-09	**Drowned Canticle within the Seal Song tradition** TSWK/Shared	The texts are neither identical nor unrelated. The Drowned Canticle is Thalara's cultural Shattered Veil version and survives within or alongside the larger Seal Song tradition as a historical/prophetic strand. The Seal Song also encompasses pre-Drowning vows, memorial culture, identity, breathwork, sealing, pressure control, communal memory, and survival protocol.	SUPERSEDES Treating the Drowned Canticle as the whole Seal Song; treating the two as unconnected traditions DOWNSTREAM Build the Seal Song Textual Layers. Whether Tavian's fragment belongs to the Canticle, another forbidden verse, or an older layer remains open.
TCD-029 2026-09-09	**Reverie's layered magic classification** ADST/Shared	All three are true at different explanatory levels. Reverie is a Dreamwalker and natural dream conduit whose conduit nature enables her unusual Remote Viewing. Early Reverie believes she is an illegal/unlicensed Dreamwalker with a rare gift; public and institutional labels may miss the conduit nature; she learns the deeper classification later in ADST.	SUPERSEDES Either/or classification; early-character knowledge of the objective answer DOWNSTREAM Build Reverie's Classification Reveal Track, including symptoms, suspicions, proof, terminology, reveal timing, and who knows what before she does.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-030 2026-09-09	**Reverie/Cassius bond mechanics and cost** ADST/Shared	Retire physical withdrawal. Touch is safe, and separation does not make either partner sick. Passive awareness, sensory spillover, emotion, pain, or magical recognition may cross distance without creating dependency. The known major danger begins when their powers actively synchronize, merge, overlap, or channel through one another; Cassius's Labyrinth scar tries to regulate both power sources and tears, spreads, or deteriorates.	SUPERSEDES Physical-proximity requirement; mutual separation sickness; touch-as-danger romance mechanic DOWNSTREAM Build a six-level Bond Mechanics Ladder from touch through Prism/network use. Reverie's physiological/magical cost, tattoo bleeding, and permanent effects remain open.
TCD-031 2026-09-09	**Caelum's allegiance and cross-book function** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	Caelum is an independent cross-land actor with deep access to Nightmare-adjacent information, people, research, favors, markets, and operational channels, but he is not a member of the Nightmare organization. He can deliberately use nightmare magic; affinity is not allegiance. His central loyalty is not currently to Nightmare, House Aether, Remnia, Shadowmere, or one protagonist. He recurs because he pursues a larger personal objective across the current sequence and into later books.	SUPERSEDES Caelum as secret Nightmare loyalist; nightmare magic proving membership; treating him as a connective cameo or omniscient information device DOWNSTREAM Build a cross-book agenda/network dossier tracking his local purpose, knowledge sources/limits, debts, withheld information, gains, and own-story progression. "Caelum's asset" as Melena's objective status remains under review.
TCD-032 2026-09-09	**Elias Lockwood / Alexander Thorne double life** FTE/ADST/Shared	Elias voluntarily created and maintained Professor Alexander Thorne as an established Somnorian researcher/instructor identity. He traveled to Somnoria and built that life for years, beginning while Lucia preceded him in succession and Aracelia reigned. After Lucia's death, his elevation to Crown Prince made the lives increasingly incompatible. At ADST's opening Elias is missing from Remnia because he failed to return on pattern, while Thorne is not yet missing from Somnoria but is becoming unstable or compromised.	SUPERSEDES Abduction into the Thorne identity; Thorne as a recent cover created only after Elias's Remnian disappearance DOWNSTREAM TCD-062 now establishes organization-exploited research/dream compromise as the failure-to-return cause. First crossing, alias creation, credentials, helpers, teaching history, Cassius chronology, travel pattern, exact technique, and later fate remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-034 2026-09-09	**Tournament purpose, Conqueror rules, and current winner** FTE/Shared	Both functions are canon. Publicly, the Conqueror—the surviving Piece whose decisive sanctioned action earns victory—holds the winning province's Provincial Leadership Board seat for the next year. Conqueror is not automatically the King or any fixed rank. Privately, the Sanctum uses selection, assignments, challenges, stress, injuries, alliances, and survival to classify, cultivate, control, exploit, monitor, suppress, or eliminate dangerous people. Under a forfeit, Conqueror is the surviving Piece whose final sanctioned action or matchup directly produces the decisive state causing the forfeit. Atlas and Tiran's confrontation is officially a draw by intervention; Katherine and Melena produce the decisive sequence. Katherine Nicholas is the current Tournament's Conqueror.	SUPERSEDES King automatically becoming Conqueror; Atlas winning solely because he made the last physical attack before intervention; Tournament as only public governance or only secret culling; legacy climax execution DOWNSTREAM Rebuild the Katherine–Melena climax and London Town forfeit so Katherine earns the title causally. Define Checkmate, final move, forfeit adjudication, succession/proxy rules, title duration, Board powers, and victorious-province benefits.
TCD-035 2026-09-09	**Fundamental origin of magic** All four	All four modern traditions ultimately draw from one primordial magical source or substrate predating the modern division of the Tandem world. The Divide did not create four unrelated magics. Geography, environment, bodies, bloodlines, culture, survival, history, and institutions reshaped the shared power into genuinely distinct systems with non-interchangeable mechanics, costs, classifications, and understandings.	SUPERSEDES Four wholly unrelated magical origins; any reading that modern systems are interchangeable or were once one standardized spell system DOWNSTREAM Build the Tandem Magic Ancestry Map. The primordial source's nature, pre-Divide practice, divergence mechanism, surviving old principles, and cultures' relative historical accuracy remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-038 2026-09-09	**Nightmare entity's relationship to the Prism** ADST/Shared	Nightmare predates the Oneiros Prism and the present boundary system. It is not physically contained inside the artifact. It exists beyond or behind a magical boundary that the complete Prism was created for or incorporated into maintaining; this restricts Nightmare's crossing, manifestation, and full influence. Fragmentation weakens or complicates that architecture without placing entity fragments inside Prism pieces. "Cage" may survive as House Aether's limited interpretation.	SUPERSEDES Literal entity-inside-Prism model; Nightmare fragmenting with the artifact; every Prism piece containing part of Nightmare; Prism existing only to imprison this threat DOWNSTREAM Build the Nightmare–Prism Boundary Model and failure-state ladder separating entity position, boundary, Prism pieces, and Dream Network.
TCD-040 2026-09-09	**Katherine and Melena's biological relationship** FTE/Shared	Tobias Lockwood is the shared biological father of Katherine Nicholas and Melena Lockwood. Katherine's biological parents are Michelle Nicholas and Tobias; Melena's are Lucia Hastings-Lockwood and Tobias. Katherine and Melena are paternal half-sisters. Biological truth does not independently establish legal status, public records, legitimacy, title, or succession.	SUPERSEDES Lucia as Katherine's biological mother; Ethan as Katherine's biological father; conflicting legacy parentage DOWNSTREAM Build the Remnian Royal Lineage and Katherine Secrecy Record. Conception, birth, concealment, record alteration, individual knowledge, reveal path, legitimacy, and succession consequences remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-041 2026-09-09	**Remnian power structure** FTE/Shared	Remnia is a centralized empire with overlapping centers of authority. The Crown is the highest public civil and dynastic authority and directly controls London Town and imperial affairs. Provincial Leaders administer territories within the Empire; titles and structures may vary. The Provincial Leadership Board provides formal representation and can be altered by a Conqueror's one-year seat. The Elemental Court is a separate political-magical bloc influencing multiple provinces and elemental policy but not London Town. The Sanctum is semi-autonomous in magical regulation, bloodlines, Tournament law, doctrine, security, and historical control, but is neither simply subordinate to the Crown nor legally omnipotent over it.	SUPERSEDES Simple Crown-versus-Sanctum dual state; fully sovereign provinces; Sanctum as ordinary subordinate agency; Sanctum as unlimited legal ruler DOWNSTREAM Build the Remnian Power and Jurisdiction Map, including public civics versus actual closed-door power and institutional conflict procedures.
TCD-042 2026-09-09	**London Town forfeit causal chain and authority** FTE	Katherine's final sanctioned action against or for Melena prevents catastrophe, stabilizes or saves Melena, and creates the decisive state. Melena consciously chooses survival over victory rather than sacrificing more people to reach Challenge Seven. Tiran supports, communicates, or operationalizes that choice, but Bishop rank alone does not grant unilateral provincial surrender authority. The formal forfeit must be entered by the properly authorized Piece or official. The Sanctum accepts and may exploit the outcome but is not its original cause.	SUPERSEDES Melena breaking down as villain; Tiran automatically possessing unilateral authority; Sanctum forcing the original decision; passive injury attrition as the whole cause DOWNSTREAM TCD-052 fixes Maxim as alive, conscious, active King who formally authorizes the forfeit. Exact procedure and emergency command rules remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-043 2026-09-09	**Melena and Caelum's operational relationship** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	Melena and Caelum operate in a transactional alliance with coercive leverage, not a true handler–subordinate hierarchy. Caelum has Elias access, Somnorian intelligence, routes, and networks; Melena has Remnian and royal access, Tournament intelligence, Shadowmere knowledge, and information he cannot obtain. Both negotiate, withhold, resist, and act independently. "Asset" is Caelum's operational language and self-conception, not objective narration of Melena's status.	SUPERSEDES Melena as Caelum's formal subordinate; asset terminology as objective canon; either party having complete authority over the other DOWNSTREAM Build the Caelum/Melena Leverage Ledger and deal progression. Whether the relationship becomes friendship, intimacy, loyalty, rivalry, or something else remains open.
TCD-044 2026-09-09	**Silas and Isola's Book One romantic landing** 3SL	Silas and Isola become explicitly and mutually romantic during 3SL, crossing from subtext into substantial consensual physical choice before the novel ends. Their magical tether is not romance or evidence of consent. They do not end as a fully settled, publicly defined couple; the crisis, Remy's death, responsibilities, Silas's changed role, and unresolved tether still pull them onto separate immediate paths. The outline's restrained separation and future promise may survive only after the romantic line has already been crossed.	SUPERSEDES Deferring all physical romantic payoff to the sequel; using tether dependency as romantic consent; a fully settled public-couple ending DOWNSTREAM Build the Silas/Isola Romance and Tether Progression as separate chapter-level tracks. Exact scene placement, intimacy level, initiator, stopping point, verbal definition, and ending wording remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-045 2026-09-24	**Historical nature of the Divide** All four	The Divide is a two-stage historical crisis. First, a non-deliberate natural, celestial, cosmic, or magical rupture destabilized the primordial system and relations among the lands. Ancient peoples then created, adapted, bound, activated, or repurposed seals, artifacts, routes, living systems, and boundary structures in response. Their deliberate response did not cause the rupture, but it hardened its consequences into long-term separation. “Divide” may name the initiating catastrophe or the broader rupture–containment–hardening era. Long isolation accelerated specialization of one shared magical ancestry; migration may be a consequence, not the cause.	SUPERSEDES Divide as solely migration; solely deliberate partition; solely natural catastrophe with no containment response; origin of four unrelated magics DOWNSTREAM Build the Divide Reconstruction. TCD-055 now establishes the Drowning as later and distinct, and First Seal as later local containment. Rupture cause, continent/Prism chronology, Leviathan’s pre-First-Seal role, boundary intent, and duration remain open.
TCD-048 2026-09-24	**Selah/Katherine Elders’ Prayer causal relationship** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Selah and Katherine independently perform the same inherited Elders’ Prayer approximately two years apart. Their connection is shared magical ancestry and ritual tradition, not direct causation. Selah’s act leaves no specific echo, reservoir contribution, transmitted route, or power that Katherine later accesses.	SUPERSEDES Direct performance-to-performance echo; Selah powering Katherine; a stored magical reservoir or route transmission between the two acts DOWNSTREAM Build the Elders’ Prayer Transmission + Variant Record: ritual ancestry tree, Selah/Katherine comparison, activation conditions, transmission history, cultural and objective interpretations, and cross-book recognition.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-049 2026-09-24	**Katherine's Fire/Frost magical anatomy** FTE/Shared	Katherine is not objectively the same Fire/Frost Dyad as Zephyr. Her manifestation is ancestral reversion or resurfacing of a less-specialized earlier Remnian elemental inheritance. She genuinely possesses both Frost and Fire; Fire is not borrowed, temporary, or merely a reaction to Melena. The Sanctum likely labels her a Dyad because current taxonomy lacks a better category, but that diagnosis is incomplete or wrong. Zephyr remains a genuine modern Fire/Frost Dyad.	SUPERSEDES Simple objective Dyad equivalence; settled Crossblood anatomy; borrowed or temporary Fire; Melena creating Katherine's Fire DOWNSTREAM TCD-058 establishes one capacity with Frost dominance and catastrophic Frost-failure Fire rerouting; no magical suppression is established. Objective name, ancient norm, inheritance, anomalies, precise failure beat, simultaneous use, and costs remain open.
TCD-050 2026-09-24	**Katherine–Melena sister-reveal architecture** FTE/Shared	The reveal proceeds through investigation, confrontation, verification, and personal confirmation. Melena begins finding inconsistencies before Challenge Six because 3SL destroyed her trust in official history. Before the Duel she has enough evidence to suspect Katherine is biologically connected to the Lockwoods/Tobias, not enough to prove it. Their climax confrontation provides magical, behavioral, and inherited recognition that reinforces suspicion but does not establish paternity. Melena directly tells/confronts Katherine. Authenticated lineage, birth, or Sanctum evidence then proves Tobias's paternity; Michelle's later testimony supplies the human history and concealment. Katherine saves or stabilizes Melena because of her own moral arc, not only sisterhood.	SUPERSEDES One magical reaction, single file, or exposition scene proving the whole reveal; sisterhood as Katherine's sole reason to save Melena DOWNSTREAM Build the Sister-Reveal Evidence Architecture with four synchronized tracks—Melena's knowledge, Katherine's knowledge, available evidence, and objective truth—plus evidence chain, climax causality, Michelle layer, and disclosure ladder. First clue, exact records, sealing actor, institutional knowledge, testimony timing, and public disclosure remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-051 2026-09-24	**Origin of Atlas's black-vein deterioration** FTE/Shared	Atlas's deterioration originates in the Conduit Trial when he force-synchronizes his dense/control Frost with Katherine's reactive Frost in the same circuit. He tries to impose structure; the Frost overcorrects, turns inward, and creates a progressive synchronization injury visible through black-vein deterioration. It is not a prior ordinary accumulation of Element Rot, and no earlier Sanctum/artifact corruption or experiment is established.	SUPERSEDES Pre-existing ordinary Element Rot; retrofitted Sanctum corruption, artifact infection, or secret experiment as the origin DOWNSTREAM Build the Atlas Synchronization Injury Record. Whether the condition is acute Element Rot or a distinct pathology, why it progresses after separation, its anatomy, aggravators, cross-link, treatment, and prayer stabilization remain open.
TCD-052 2026-09-24	**Maxim's condition and authority at the London Town forfeit** FTE	Maxim is alive, conscious, and functioning as active King when the forfeit occurs. Melena makes the substantive choice of survival over victory. Tiran advises, supports, and operationalizes that choice but cannot unilaterally surrender the province. Melena brings or endorses the decision to Maxim; Maxim formally enters or authorizes the forfeit. The Sanctum accepts and formalizes it rather than compelling it. Katherine remains Conqueror because her sanctioned action creates the decisive state.	SUPERSEDES Incapacitating Maxim solely to preserve the legacy Tiran announcement; Tiran's unilateral authority; Sanctum-compelled original surrender DOWNSTREAM Add a Tournament Command Authority table and final causal sequence to the FTE Forfeit record. Maxim's initial response, private/public procedure, and emergency authority rules for King, Queen, and Bishop remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-053 2026-09-24	**Nightmare entity's ADST Book One endpoint** ADST/Shared	ADST Book One ends with the ancient Nightmare entity reaching Awareness only. Reverie, Cassius, and/or the House Aether Prism fragment become perceptible to it because of the protagonists' successful intervention and the Prism's deeper boundary response, not because the criminal organization completes its plan. The entity does not independently communicate, influence, manifest through the Dream Network, run an operation, or cross into waking reality. The protagonists win locally; the organization's immediate plan fails, but its network survives and remains dangerous. "Nightmare" in the current manuscript may reflect Reverie's incomplete knowledge rather than entity identification.	SUPERSEDES Entity communication, influence, Network manifestation, autonomous operation, or waking crossing in Book One; organization success as the source of Awareness; total antagonist defeat DOWNSTREAM TCD-060–061 now specify the failed Network-rupture/boundary-channel operation and intact fragment's unintended stabilizing resonance. Build the awakening ladder, attribution, mechanical counteraction, aftermath, and reader-reveal method. Exact perception and next-stage timing remain open.
TCD-054 2026-09-24	**Post-FTE/ADST rolling chronology** All four	TSWK and the next Shadowmere installment form the next concurrent window and begin directly after FTE/ADST, with no meaningful months- or years-long gap; days or small weeks for logistics are acceptable. The handoff is rolling: conditions for later plots may already be active during late FTE/ADST, the two next books substantially overlap without requiring identical opening dates, and still-later stories may begin activating before the prior pair fully resolves. Local conflicts remain independently rooted, so temporal proximity does not create automatic causation.	SUPERSEDES Long gap after FTE/ADST; isolated book eras; identical page-one dates as a requirement; assuming adjacent events cause one another DOWNSTREAM Update the Tandem Master Synchronization Timeline with separate Background Activation, Narrative Opening, Climax, and Resolution fields for every book. TSWK crackdown, Azrine's sanctuary, Levi's assignment, and the next Shadowmere character's continuing two-year life may predate page one.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-056 2026-09-26	**Present Convergence causal threshold** All four	E staged threshold: long-term degradation, alteration, isolation, and strain of post-Divide architecture precede the present process. By the FTE/ADST window localized Convergence is latent. Late ADST's Reverie/Cassius/Prism/Dream Network interaction is the first established threshold shifting largely independent local instabilities toward responsive cross-system instability; ancient Nightmare Awareness is an indicator/consequence, not its origin. Late FTE is a major Remnian manifestation, not yet an equal proven trigger. TSWK/next Shadowmere unfold after this threshold. Not every local anomaly is Convergence.	SUPERSEDES ADST climax as creation of centuries of degradation; Nightmare Awareness as initiating cause; every FTE/Thalaran/Underside anomaly automatically a co-trigger; Leviathan-only origin DOWNSTREAM Add causal timeline, symptom ledger with real non-Convergence classifications, tested arrow-by-arrow threshold chain, and T0 cross-land response clock to the Convergence State Model. Onset definition, first measurable cross-land effects, FTE trigger status, and Leviathan/Underside timing remain open.
TCD-057 2026-09-26	**Elders' Prayer objective function** 3SL/FTE/Shared	E C+B hybrid: the inherited working restores a living person's viable magical/life pattern when severed, corrupted, or catastrophically dysregulated. Restored magical continuity can stabilize secondary bodily functions and call someone back from active dying while a viable living pattern remains. It cannot resurrect completed death or regenerate destroyed anatomy; Isola's leg remains ruined despite life-saving stabilization. Silas's returning breath/pulse under Selah is recovery of living function, not resurrection. Selah/Katherine share this objective function through differing cultural presentations.	SUPERSEDES Resurrection of completed death; full physical regeneration; Frost-only ritual; automatic universal burden redistribution DOWNSTREAM Add Functional Anatomy to the Elders' Prayer Transmission + Variant Record: failure-state eligibility, original-pattern reference, possible mechanical sequence, both performances, death threshold, caster cost, bond requirement, and cultural variants. Exact eligibility and effects on Atlas/Melena remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-058 2026-09-26	**Katherine's Frost-dominant Fire emergence** FTE/Shared	E refined C: Katherine's one less-specialized ancestral elemental capacity naturally organized itself around a dominant Frost expression from childhood, reinforced by modern Frost training. Fire is a genuine alternative expression of the same capacity, not a separate ordinary Dyad channel, borrowed ability, or established magically sealed second element. Ordinary stress/Fire exposure does not activate it. In FTE's climax catastrophic severance or unavailability of her established Frost configuration lets the older capacity reroute through what modern Remnia calls Fire. Deliberate magical suppression is not currently established; unusual readings or institutional suspicion are possible but open.	SUPERSEDES Fire triggered by generic stress or exposure; two ordinary Fire/Frost channels; external seal/medical suppression as established cause; interpreting legacy "Fire is back" as proof of Katherine's childhood Fire use DOWNSTREAM Add Katherine Expression Architecture to the elemental dossier: one-capacity/multiple-expression anatomy, Frost dominance, Examination baseline, exact climax Frost failure, Fire rerouting, later switching/dual access/cost, tests and misclassification.
TCD-059 2026-09-26	**Katherine's layered lineage concealment** FTE/Shared	E multi-party: Lucia/the Lockwood Crown originates Katherine's public/legal and dynastic erasure; Sanctum is principal institutional enforcer and record/surveillance custodian; Tobias cooperates by non-acknowledgment without being established as the architect; Michelle raises and protects Katherine inside imposed constraints rather than designing her erasure. Each controls a different layer. Exact motives, coercion/consent, record alterations, Aracelia's role, and whether Katherine's birth was publicly known before suppression or never meaningfully acknowledged remain open.	SUPERSEDES Michelle as architect; Sanctum as original decision-maker; Tobias's silence equated with indifference; silent settlement of conflicting initial-publicity accounts DOWNSTREAM Build Katherine Concealment Architecture as layered record/decision/knowledge matrix integrated with the TCD-050 sister-reveal board and secrecy timeline.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-060 2026-09-26	**Nightmare organization's ADST Book One operation** ADST/Shared	E A+C hybrid: the criminal organization uses Thorne's completed research, a rare celestial alignment, and a living conduit/anchor configuration to deliberately rupture the Dream Network. The rupture is a means to force a usable channel or critical weakness in Somnoria's older boundary architecture toward the ancient entity, not the end goal. Reverie is targeted for her conduit nature; Cassius and the fragment can become important without the organization foreseeing a fixed trio. Reverie/Cassius stop the intended Network rupture/boundary breach. The Network survives sufficiently to function; ancient Nightmare gains no usable channel. Its later Awareness is an unintended result of the protagonists' successful intervention and the fragment response.	SUPERSEDES Entity personally operating Book One attack; artifact theft as whole operation; completed Network destruction/breach; organization necessarily predicting the exact paired/fragment configuration DOWNSTREAM Add ADST Climax Operation Map to the existing outcome/awakening record: asset roles and knowledge, intended-versus-actual sequence, dreamer stakes, Thorne's exact role, protagonist countermechanism, and aftermath.
TCD-061 2026-09-26	**House Aether Prism fragment's climax state** ADST/Shared	A clarified with limited C: Reverie/Cassius's combined intervention engages House Aether's intact fragment in a deeper boundary-stabilization function that helps prevent Nightmare's Network rupture becoming a breach. It reacts unusually to the pair, but no permanent attunement, ownership, exclusive access, or effortless repeat activation follows. Its structural correction sends unintended boundary-scale resonance, making the ancient entity Aware without deliberately messaging it or completing Nightmare's goal. The fragment does not fracture further, vanish, or relocate; it remains physically present.	SUPERSEDES Fragment breaking/vanishing in Book One; automatic keeper assignment; conscious Prism beacon; entity Awareness as proof of a successful breach; convenient reveal of all other fragment locations DOWNSTREAM Add Prism Climax State Record to TCD-053/060: pre-crisis, overload, paired activation, stabilization, aftermath; specify energy redirection, distinct Reverie/Cassius contributions, non-repeatability, continued custody/access, fragment state, and institutional knowledge.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-062 2026-09-26	**Elias/Thorne's failure to return** FTE/ADST/Shared	E B+C hybrid: Nightmare the organization targets Thorne's boundary/Network research and exploits the vulnerability created by his own exposure, operationally compromising dream/magical functioning so ordinary return to Remnia becomes unsafe or impossible without requiring initial physical captivity. Remnia notices Elias missing first; Thorne initially remains publicly present but deteriorating in Somnoria. Reverie's encounter with his collapsing dream, breakdown rumors, and Professor Lane's mirrored case reflect real patterned compromise. Exact technique, later captivity, protective self-isolation, travel risk, consent in the final operation, and physical status remain open.	SUPERSEDES Abduction into the Thorne identity; casual elective extended stay as entire cause; ancient entity personally attacking him in Book One; purely self-inflicted research madness; unproven House Aether/Council detention DOWNSTREAM Integrate a staged Failure-to-Return Sequence in the Elias/Thorne Double-Life Timeline + Knowledge Matrix with two public clocks, Nightmare interventions, diminishing Elias agency, identity collision, and exact pre-chapter-one and climax conditions.
TCD-063 2026-09-26	**Remy's objective death mechanism and Melena's guilt** 3SL/FTE	A clarified: the gang leader mortally wounds Remy as he deliberately intervenes to protect/rescue Melena. Melena's escalating uncontrolled Fire helps create the dangerous confrontation, but neither her Fire nor the later warehouse collapse is the objective lethal mechanism. After the wound, Melena attempts to save him but cannot stop catastrophic bleeding; his death then drives her Fire into full loss of control and the blaze/collapse. She feels causally responsible even though the gang leader physically kills him. The Beta's machete/major-artery details are compatible candidates, not canon over the future 3SL scene.	SUPERSEDES Melena directly burning Remy to death; collapse as fatal event; accidental intervention; old "directly caused by Melena" as forensic truth DOWNSTREAM Build a 3SL Remy Death Beat Sheet before drafting the climax, with objective events versus FTE Melena memory. Exact attacker motive, intervention action, weapon/anatomy, antagonist fate, witnesses, and fire/collapse proportions remain open.

ID · DATE	TOPIC · BOOKS	AUTHOR RULING	SUPERSEDES · DOWNSTREAM
TCD-064 2026-09-26	**Levi and the Leviathan / House Dren Anchor system** TSWK/Shared	E A+clarified D: Levi is fully human, not a shard, reincarnation, avatar, or soulprint of Leviathan. House Dren has genuine inherited compatibility with Leviathan-associated seal infrastructure, expressed through pressure tolerance and interface ability. The House made a hereditary Anchor system identifying, conditioning, marking/authorizing compatible children and sacrificing some within the system. First currently established Anchor Caelen was twelve, not the willing adult in House mythology. Levi is the current intended operator; his capacity does not entail consent, ownership, or obligation. The Leviathan does not choose, claim, bless, or possess him in Book One; it watches after the system is opened. His name reflects institutional history, not metaphysical identity.	SUPERSEDES Legacy Soulprint Echo/reincarnated line; compatibility as consent; entity choosing/claiming Levi in Book One; Caelen as willing adult hero DOWNSTREAM Build the Dren Anchor Line + Seal Interface Record separating inherited compatibility, bodily conditioning, and Shellmark authorization; track Caelen to Levi, official versus objective history, sacrifices, inheritance source, and whether reproductive selection occurred. The July 2026 blueprint is now inventoried; resolve its 'Cael Dren' tablet and pre-Drowning Anchor-school terminology without silently overriding this ruling.

AUTHOR RULINGS WITHOUT A TCD NUMBER

DATE	TOPIC	AUTHOR RULING	WHERE
2026-08-22	**Graveshand and Severance: the five laws**	Approved as the working continuity baseline for Graveshand and Severance (connection required; understanding required; every ending leaves remains; remains can follow the connection home; the body imitates the ending).	APPLIED IN III.8

APPENDIX A · CANON DECISION LOG · 3SL SLICE

CONTINUED

DATE	TOPIC	AUTHOR RULING	WHERE
2026-10-09	**Underside tier status**	CANON — TCD-0025 / TCD-0026: the Underside is vertically tiered and attached to Zenithia's side of Remnia; Crownlight and Dawnveil are surface/above-ground tiers; the nation is fully underground by Ironcross. DRAFTED — 3SL ch. 10: the Underside has nine tiers; the route board lists all nine in order. SUPPORTED — 3SL Full Worldbuilding: tier functions and other worldbuilding detail where not independently drafted or ruled. The nine-tier count is not promoted to ruled canon.	APPLIED IN III.3 · III.20

LOGGED IN DRAFTING · RESOLVED III.20 ITEMS · ASKING A QUESTION ASSIGNS NO TCD NUMBER

LOG NO.	III.20 ITEM	DECISION AS MADE IN PROSE OR RULED	DATE · CH. · PAGES TO UPDATE

APPENDIX A · CANON DECISION LOG · 3SL SLICE

CONTINUED

LOG NO.	III.20 ITEM	DECISION AS MADE IN PROSE OR RULED	DATE · CH. · PAGES TO UPDATE

APPENDIX · STATUS & PROVENANCE SHEET

B HIGH-IMPACT CONFLICT REGISTER: 3SL SLICE

Conflicts that touch 3SL, plus every conflict this volume cites.

Rows reproduced from the audit's High-Impact Conflict Register. Included: every register entry whose books include 3SL, and every entry cited elsewhere in this volume (14 rows).

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-002	**3SL remaining plot and ending** 3SL/FTE	Current manuscript execution vs 32-ch outline/locked Remy-death climax	Resolved at authority/romantic-outcome level by TCD-002 and TCD-044; remaining climax bridge and exact romance beats require development
HC-004	**Graveshand/Deathwork classification** 3SL/Shared	Central on-page practice absent from Six Disciplines taxonomy	Resolved by TCD-004
HC-012	**Nature and reach of routes** 3SL/TSWK/Shared	Ordinary Underside passages vs magical cross-land or neutral-transit descriptions	Resolved at principle level by TCD-017 and TCD-027; Echo Gate retired and a current Remnia–Underside crossing confirmed, while individual route capabilities remain to be classified
HC-017	**Selah/Katherine prayer relationship** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Same ritual, causal echo, or merely thematic parallel	Resolved by TCD-023 and TCD-048: same inherited working in divergent forms, independently performed about two years apart with no direct performance-to-performance echo or borrowed power

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-018	**Placement of TSWK/next Shadowmere era** 3SL/FTE/ADST/TSWK	Their mutual overlap is established, but sources do not consistently place them against the FTE/ADST window	Resolved at window level by TCD-024 and TCD-054: rolling handoff directly after FTE/ADST, allowing only days/small weeks, with substantial TSWK/Shadowmere overlap and separate activation/opening/climax/resolution dates
HC-020	**Underside physical placement** 3SL/FTE/Shared	“Buried realm” language could imply a nation wholly beneath another land or an independent vertical territory	Resolved by TCD-026: vertical nation attached to Zenithia’s side of Remnia; surface upper tiers, fully underground by Ironcross
HC-025	**Caelum’s allegiance** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	Nightmare magic, Nightmare access, House Aether kinship, and cross-book manipulation could imply incompatible loyalties	Resolved at identity and Melena-relationship level by TCD-031 and TCD-043: independent cross-land actor, not a Nightmare member or Melena’s formal handler; full agenda remains open
HC-037	**Melena/Caelum power relationship** 3SL/FTE/ADST/Shared	“Caelum’s asset” conflicts with Melena’s bargaining, resistance, and independent choices	Resolved by TCD-043: transactional alliance with coercive leverage; asset is Caelum’s framing, not objective subordination
HC-038	**Silas/Isola Book One romantic landing** 3SL	Outline defers physical payoff while the current manuscript intensifies attraction and imposes a nonconsensual magical tether	Resolved at outcome level by TCD-044: voluntary romance becomes physically explicit before a still-unsettled ending; tether is not consent

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-042	**Elders' Prayer direct causality** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Shared working could be a later character accessing an earlier magical echo or reservoir	Resolved by TCD-048: independent performances connected only by inherited tradition; no specific echo, reservoir contribution, route transmission, or borrowed power
HC-051	**Elders' Prayer effect and death boundary** 3SL/FTE/Shared	Silas regains breath/pulse and Atlas may recover, allowing mistaken resurrection, generic healing, or burden-transfer explanations	Resolved by TCD-057: restores viable living magical pattern and secondary physiology, can recover active dying threshold but never completed death or full tissue regeneration; exact cost/eligibility mechanics open
HC-057	**Remy's death: forensic cause versus moral guilt** 3SL/FTE	Older 3SL character phrasing blames Melena directly; outline and Beta memory point to gang leader wound during rescue	Resolved by TCD-063: gang leader mortally wounds Remy as he deliberately protects Melena; her escalating Fire creates circumstances and his death precedes catastrophic blaze; exact weapon/anatomy remain subordinate to future 3SL draft
HC-059	**First Dren Anchor versus credited seal designer** TSWK	July 2026 blueprint ch. 29 calls 'Cael Dren' the man who designed the sacrificial route and First Anchor; chs. 38–39 reveal twelve-year-old Caelen as first Anchor	Deferred to TSWK draft/reveal design; do not identify the credited designer as the child or state who designed the route as fact; protect TCD-064's twelve-year-old Caelen

APPENDIX B · CONFLICT REGISTER · 3SL SLICE CONTINUED

ID	TOPIC · BOOKS	CONFLICT	PRIORITY / STATUS
HC-061	**TSWK Book One ending and shared-system effects** TSWK/ADST/Shared	Working blueprint commits to Tavian's death, ordination, Levi opening the outward route, freed/observing Leviathan, Skyhold blackout, Oneiros response, and surviving wall symbols; TCD-012 leaves ending open and TCD-056 fixes ADST as first active cross-system threshold	Deferred to Book One drafting; record components as provisional blueprint beats, not canonical outcomes; preserve ADST's earlier cross-system threshold

APPENDIX · STATUS & PROVENANCE SHEET

C SOURCE AUTHORITY INVENTORY: 3SL SLICE

The 3SL files, plus the two non-3SL files Part III leans on.

Rows reproduced from the audit's Source Inventory: all four 3SL files, the FTE Beta (which controls Melena's FTE memory of Shadowmere), and *Novel Constraints* (named in Part III's source note). TKC files have zero Tandem authority and are listed only in the full Companion.

FILE · BOOK · TYPE	GENERATION · DOMAINS	STATUS	KNOWN HIGH-IMPACT CONFLICT
3 Shadowmere Lane First Draft(9).docx 3SL · Manuscript, 22 chapters	Current drafted generation; revised through 2026-08-19 DOMAINS On-page chronology, POV, characterization, plot, Graveshand/Deathwork execution	Current for drafted pages	Diverges from the 32-chapter outline after the midpoint; stops with Remy alive and the transit route unresolved. TCD-044 requires voluntary romance to cross into explicit physical choice while keeping the nonconsensual tether mechanically distinct from consent.
3 Shadowmere Lane Chapter Outline(3).docx 3SL · Expanded 32-chapter outline	Pre/current-manuscript plan DOMAINS Provisional future plot plus fixed climax anchors	Supporting	Chapter mapping no longer controls. TCD-063 locks Remy's deliberate intervention and fatal wound from the gang leader, followed by Melena's catastrophic Fire escalation; exact weapon/wound is provisional. Tiran's cleanup remains fixed. Its restrained physical separation/future-promise ending may survive, but not deferral of all Silas/Isola romantic payoff.
3SL Character Outlines(5).docx 3SL · Character bible/outlines	Foundational character generation DOMAINS Histories, relationships, motivations, age progression	Supporting	Top-sheet ages describe a later time jump; opening ages align with locked constraints. Older language calling Melena the direct cause of Remy's death is emotional/indirect causation, not the objective fatal mechanism under TCD-063.

FILE · BOOK · TYPE	GENERATION · DOMAINS	STATUS	KNOWN HIGH-IMPACT CONFLICT
3SL Full Worldbuilding(4).docx 3SL · Worldbuilding/magic/institutions	Foundational Underside generation DOMAINS Nine tiers, Synod, culture, economy, formal Six Disciplines	Supporting, clarified by rulings	TCD-004 places Graveshand outside the Six Disciplines. TCD-025–026 establish the Underside's vertical geography. TCD-035 places all Underside practices within a distinct modern branch of the shared primordial magical substrate without making them interchangeable with other lands' magic.
FTE Official Beta Reader Copy.docx FTE · Partial revised manuscript, through ch. 29	Current controlling prose generation DOMAINS On-page POV, characterization, plot, rules for revised chapters	Current for drafted pages	Incomplete; all material outside this generation must be rewritten before it becomes canon. TCD-058 explains its severe Fire-trauma Examination still producing Frost; TCD-063 establishes Remy's objective fatal cause while exact Beta flashback weapon/wound awaits 3SL draft. TCD-040 and TCD-049–052, TCD-059 control parentage, magic, injury, reveal, concealment, and forfeit.
Novel Constraints(2).docx Shared/all four · Locked constraint sheet	Jan. 2026 consolidated generation with targeted corrections DOMAINS Book order, core settings, magic, protagonists, major plot engines	Current, subject to logged rulings	TCD-004/005 clarify Graveshand and fragment chain; TCD-029–030 clarify Reverie/Cassius; TCD-049 and TCD-058 replace simple Dyad/suppressed-second-channel readings of Katherine; TCD-060–061 define a survivable Network-rupture climax; TCD-064 rejects Levi as reincarnated entity; TCD-054 fixes rolling handoff. "Caelum's asset" is only his framing per TCD-043.

APPENDIX · TERMINOLOGY REGISTER

TERMINOLOGY REGISTER: 3SL SLICE

E

Print version of Production Control A7, limited to the terms this volume uses.

These terms carry rulings; drafters use them exactly. 16 of the register's 18 terms appear in this volume.

TERM	REQUIRED USAGE	GOVERNING RULING
Graveshand	Inherited Graves-family magic, outside the formal Six Disciplines	TCD-004
Deathwork	Broader category of ending-magic and its effects	TCD-004
Routes	Physical-magical transit through real passages; never portals	TCD-017
Echo Gate	LEGACY only	TCD-027
Oneiros Prism	Fragmented cross-land artifact; "the Prism" alone must not imply the whole is held	TCD-018, TCD-019
Nightmare (organization)	The criminal organization; say "the Nightmare organization" when ambiguous	TCD-020
ancient Nightmare / the entity	The ancient entity; at ADST Book One's end, Aware only	TCD-020, TCD-053
Crossblood	Contested institutional/scholarly label, never objective biology	TCD-036
Dyad (for Katherine)	The Sanctum's incomplete label; objectively she is not Zephyr's kind of Dyad	TCD-049, TCD-058
Conqueror	Surviving Piece whose decisive sanctioned action earns victory; not automatically the King	TCD-034
The Conduit Trials	Working title for Challenge Four; always flag the name as open	TCD-008
Levi / Cael	Levi is default; Cael is a nickname from Caelis; full name Leviathan Caelis Dren	TCD-011

TERM	REQUIRED USAGE	GOVERNING RULING
Leviathan	The living pressure entity; never Levi	TCD-064
Drowned Canticle / Seal Song	Canticle is Thalara's Shattered Veil version within or alongside the broader Seal Song	TCD-028
Divide / Drowning	Ancient rupture-plus-response vs later Thalaran regional catastrophe	TCD-045, TCD-055
Convergence	A transition state, never an outcome	TCD-046, TCD-056